

HARD TO STOMACH

What urban food habits do to Indians

Study finds link between urban diets and gut microbiomes that could be reason behind rising diabetes and other lifestyle diseases in the country

NEWS » PAGE 14



Bill in U.S. Senate seeks three-year pause on H-1B visas

WORLD » PAGE 20



What is the Saudi Arabia-U.S. nuclear deal about?

FAQ » PAGE 18



Para powerlifter Jhandu wins India's first medal at Glasgow

SPORT » PAGE 21

NEARBY



Stalin urges Vijay to rethink talks with Karnataka

CHENNAI DMK chief M.K. Stalin has urged CM C. Joseph Vijay to abandon his “misguided decision” to visit Karnataka for talks on the Cauvery issue. » PAGE 6

Senthilbalaji and brother appear for inquiry

CHENNAI DMK MLA V. Senthilbalaji and his brother V. Ashok Kumar on Saturday appeared before police in connection with the inquiry into an alleged attempt to poach TVK MLAs. » PAGE 6

T.N. to ink pact for PDS grievance redress system

CHENNAI Tamil Nadu will soon sign a MoU with the Centre for adopting an AI-enabled grievance redressal system for PDS beneficiaries. » PAGE 6

CLASSIFIEDS » PAGES 8, 9 & 10
MAGAZINE » 8 PAGES
DOWNTOWN » 8 PAGES
TABLOID (IN SELECT AREAS)
CAREER PATH » 6 PAGES
(A SPACE MARKETING INITIATIVE)

Dharmendra Pradhan quits; CJP calls off stir

We have done it, says Abhijeet Dipke; President appoints Pralhad Joshi as Education Minister

This is a signal to farmers, labourers, poor people to stand up to the oppressive govt., says Rahul Gandhi

Kharge seeks stringent action against those who ‘unleashed lathis and pellet guns’ on students

Sandeep Phukan
Nistula Hebbar
NEW DELHI

As the student protests over paper leaks spread across different States and snowballed into a major political crisis for the Narendra Modi government, Dharmendra Pradhan resigned as the Education Minister on Saturday, prompting the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) to call off the protests at Jantar Mantar, which had become the epicentre of the agitation for the past 36 days.

President Droupadi Murmu accepted Mr. Pradhan's resignation and appointed Pralhad Joshi as the Education Minister. In his resignation letter addressed to Prime Minister, Mr. Pradhan said he was stepping down on his own account, so that “anti-national” elements do not exploit the situation created by the protests.

Protesters celebrate

As soon as the news of the resignation broke in the afternoon, protesters at Jantar Mantar erupted in joy. “We have done it,” CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke told the jubilant crowd.

Activist Sonam Wangchuk, whose hunger strike gave momentum to the protests, termed it a victory



One voice: CJP supporters celebrate at Jantar Mantar after Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan's resignation. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

ry of democracy, peace, patience, and perseverance. “Congratulations CJP, Gen Z of the nation, and thank you all citizens for shedding fear and the fear of fear, and rising up from every corner of the nation,” he posted on X.

The resignation came moments before Union Ministers J.P. Nadda and Jitendra Singh met CJP spokespersons Ashutosh Ranka and Saurav Das for talks to end the protests.

At a joint press conference with the Ministers, the CJP spokespersons said

they are calling the protest off in “good faith” as the government had agreed to their two demands: ₹1 crore to the families of all students who died by suicide after the NEET cancellation and no action against any of the student protesters.

Mr. Nadda said the government will give “honourable compensation” within rules to the families of the students who died by suicide and ensure withdrawal of all FIRs registered against the protesters. “As far as their [CJP]

charter for broader education reforms is concerned, we will deliberate upon and engage with them,” he said.

‘PM should apologise’

Congratulating the students on their victory, Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi said exit of Mr. Pradhan is a “symbolic” but huge step in rebuilding the education system.

He, however, said there are still two more demands: anyone who beat up the students should be

held accountable and that the Prime Minister should apologise to the students.

“It is also a signal to other parts of society, farmers, labourers, poor people, anybody whom this regime is attacking and oppressing, there is wisdom and courage in standing up. *Daro mat* (do not fear). Let us get rid of this regime,” Mr. Gandhi said.

In a post on X, Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge said: “The Prime Minister should apologise to youth. There should be strict action against those

Centre to table Bill to strengthen anti-cheating law

NEW DELHI Union Minister Dr. Jitendra Singh is set to introduce the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Amendment Bill, 2026, which seeks to strengthen the anti-cheating law, in the Lok Sabha on Monday. The proposed legislation, a copy of which was circulated among MPs on Saturday, significantly toughens the penalties established under the 2024 Act, introduces mandatory two-month investigation deadlines, and imposes penalties reaching up to ₹10 crore for organised crime networks. » PAGE 12

Three protesters injured as police open fire in Bihar

PATNA At least three protesters sustained bullet wounds and several police officers reported injuries from stone-pelting in Siwan district of Bihar on Saturday as a State-wide bandh called by the All India Students' Association over the NEET issue turned violent. While police fired 10 rounds in Siwan, incidents of stone-pelting were reported in several districts, including capital Patna. Though a heavy deployment of the police force was made in the State capital, the large number of students managed to lodge their protest. » PAGE 13

who unleashed lathis and pellet guns.”

With the first week of the Monsoon Session of Parliament washed out over the Opposition's insistence on Mr. Pradhan's resignation, the government is now expecting both Houses to function.

Amid the jubilation at Jantar Mantar, there were also tense moments, as three senior police officials were injured in stone-throwing near the protest site. Police personnel quickly restored order by using tear gas and resort-

ing to a mild lathi-charge.

Sources said the government had come around to the view on Friday evening that it would be necessary for Mr. Pradhan to resign in order to end the spiralling protests, which appeared to be spreading across the country. With Delhi University set to reopen soon and protests spreading to tier-II cities, discretion was considered the better part of valour, the sources added.

DETAILED COVERAGE
» PAGES 5, 6, 12, & 13

Maharashtra TET paper leak accused, aide held from Bihar

Amit Bhelari
Vinaya Deshpande Pandit
PATNA/MUMBAI

The Maharashtra Police on Saturday arrested Bijendra Kumar Gupta, the prime accused in the Maharashtra Teacher Eligibility Test (TET) paper leak case, from Bihar along with his associate Indrajit Singh. Mr. Gupta was picked up from Samastipur, his home district, and arrested in Patna at around 1 a.m.

Later in the day, the two were flown from Patna to Pune and taken to Bhiwandi by road.

A court in Bhiwandi remanded them to police custody till July 30.

“Bijendra Kumar is the mastermind in this case. He has several offences registered against him in different parts of the country. He used to handle the media and the other accused, who used to sell the leaked papers. He was also an accused in two more cases in Odisha. To evade arrest in this case, Bijendra used the fake identity of ‘Abhishek Mahato’. He created a



Police bring Bijendra Kumar Gupta and Indrajit Singh, accused in the Maharashtra TET paper leak, to Thane on Saturday. ANI

forged Aadhaar card and a driving licence in that name. He used these documents to buy SIM cards,” a senior Maharashtra Police official told *The Hindu*.

Mr. Singh, alias Piku, is accused of harbouring Mr. Gupta in Bihar. Police also alleged that he was involved in Mr. Gupta's activities in Delhi, and was aware of the TET paper leak.

The TET 2026 was postponed on June 27, a day before it was scheduled to be held, after the police in Thane district found that a

portion of the question paper had been leaked and arrested three people.

The SIT found that the racket was spread across Delhi, Agra, Bihar, and Haryana. The TET paper leak, which followed the nationwide controversy over the NEET-UG paper leak, affected nearly six lakh candidates.

With the latest arrests, the total number of accused held in the case has increased to 14.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 12

Centre again rules out Metro Rail projects for Madurai, Coimbatore

Sunitha Sekar
CHENNAI

For the second time, the Centre ruled out Metro Rail projects for Coimbatore and Madurai and recommended the implementation of Bus Rapid Transit Systems (BRTS) instead.

In November last year, the Centre rejected the request of the Tamil Nadu government to implement Metro Rail systems in both these cities, stating that such projects may not result in significant time savings for commuters or high ridership and that the cities did not have the mandated population of two million as per the 2011 Census.

Following this, in May this year, the State government yet again wrote to the Centre, justifying and emphasising the need for Metro Rail systems in both the cities, sources said.

The government said Tamil Nadu is one of the most urbanised States in the country, and that

The Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs recommends Bus Rapid Transit Systems for the cities

Coimbatore is an industrial-cum-tourist hub while Madurai is a tourist hub. Hence, resident population aside, both cities would benefit from having a Metro Rail, as they attract floating populations and tourists, sources added.

A few days ago, the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs communicated to the State government that it had turned down the proposal again, and that the State could build an elevated or at-grade BRTS for both cities.

It said population was not the sole criterion to implement Metro Rail systems and both proposals were returned after being examined “in entirety”.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 6

U.S.'s new 10% tariffs will not affect 45% of exports: Centre

T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan
NEW DELHI

A day after the U.S. announced permanent tariffs on imports from 60 trading partners over forced labour goods, the Centre on Saturday said that about 45% of India's exports to the U.S. remains outside the purview of the new 10% tariff.

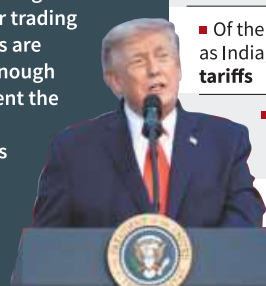
The government also said that it remained engaged with the U.S. regarding a quota-based system regarding India's textile exports to the U.S.

The statement by the Ministry of Commerce and Industry on Saturday highlighted that the new 10% tariff is lower than the initially proposed 12.5% on India and some other countries.

It said that “a substantial share” of India's exports to the U.S., such as generic pharmaceuticals, smartphones, and certain other specified products, currently attract zero additional duties and continue to remain outside the

Tariff matters

The new tariffs follow a U.S. investigation into whether trading partners are doing enough to prevent the import of goods made using forced labour



- U.S.'s 10% tariffs are lower than the 12.5% it initially proposed
- Tariffs are on 60 countries that U.S. says have failed to stop the import of goods made using forced labour
- Of the 60, 16 have the same rate as India, while 38 face higher tariffs
- India says 45% of exports to the U.S. will not face these tariffs
- India-U.S. trade deal is still in the works that could alter the tariff arrangement further

scope of the additional 10% tariff.

Apart from these, the Ministry said that products already covered under Section 232 of the U.S. Trade Expansion Act such as steel, aluminium, and auto parts, are not subject to the additional 10% duty.

Further, it pointed out that the tariffs under Section 232, which had been levied last year and that range between 25-50%, are levied equally on nearly all countries, thereby not putting India at a disadvantage

in this regard. “On account of these exemptions, an estimated 45% of India's exports to the U.S. remain outside the purview of the additional 10% duty,” the statement said.

It also acknowledged that the remaining 55% of exports will attract the additional 10% duty, but said that India's “tariff incidence is comparatively lower than that for most other economies”.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 12



In the eye of the storm: A view of the land belonging to the Dhandayuthapani Swamy Temple in Palani. It was illegally registered in the names of private individuals, and the registration was later cancelled. G. KARTHIKEYAN

Trouble over temple land

First, it was Thirupparankundram, and now, it is Palani; southern Tamil Nadu has been the bed of controversies surrounding religious places for a while now. The title and ownership of a parcel of land, said to be within the precincts of the Dhandayuthapani Swamy Temple, are under debate, becoming the first such crisis the TVK government has had to handle. **B. Tilak Chandar** finds out all about the case, along with **L. Srikrishna** and **S. Sundar**

It is best to start at the beginning of any story. This one begins here: A patch of 1.40 acres of land located in Palani town in Dindigul district was originally owned by Kuppusamy Maniyakarar of Balasamuthiram. This is from the records of the Hindu Religious and Charitable Endowments (HR&CE) Department.

He had donated the land through a gift deed to one Dhandapani Swamy in 1888 with the objective of establishing a math. Later, the math was developed by several persons and buildings were constructed for providing shelter to devotees visiting the Dhandayuthapani Swamy Temple in the town. The proceeds of the land were willed for maintenance of the math and performance of puja and other services to the temple.

“No one was given the rights to sell the land or create encumbrance to it; hence, the land became the property of the trust. The land belonging to the trust could not be sold by any individual,” the then Joint Director and Executive Officer of the temple, S. Marimuthu, said in a letter addressed to the Joint Sub-Registrar of Palani days before the land was registered on July 7.

Interestingly, there have been multiple attempts to sell the land in the past. Dhandapani Ayya, a descendant of Dhandapani Swamy in whose name the land had been vested for developing the math, had sold the land to private individuals in 1999. Then, with the objective of safeguarding the land, the HR&CE Commissioner on June 17, 1999 appointed the Joint Commissioner (JC) and Executive Officer of the temple as the *Thakkar* or fitperson to administer the land.

Meanwhile, all legal efforts made by Dhandapani Ayya to remove the JC as the fitperson of the land in different courts, including the civil court, the Madras High Court, and the Supreme Court, failed. The High Court in 2002 observed that Dhandapani Ayya was not the owner and possessor of the trust property.

A subsequent inquiry conducted by the then JC of the HR&CE Department, Madurai, under the HR&CE Act, ruled that the math did not belong to any private persons but was a public property. This was confirmed by the HR&CE Commissioner in 2016. Against this backdrop, Mr. Marimuthu wrote a letter on July 2, 2026 to the Joint Sub-Registrar in the office of the District Sub-Registrar, Palani, revealing that attempts had been made in 2025 to register the land in the name of private individuals.

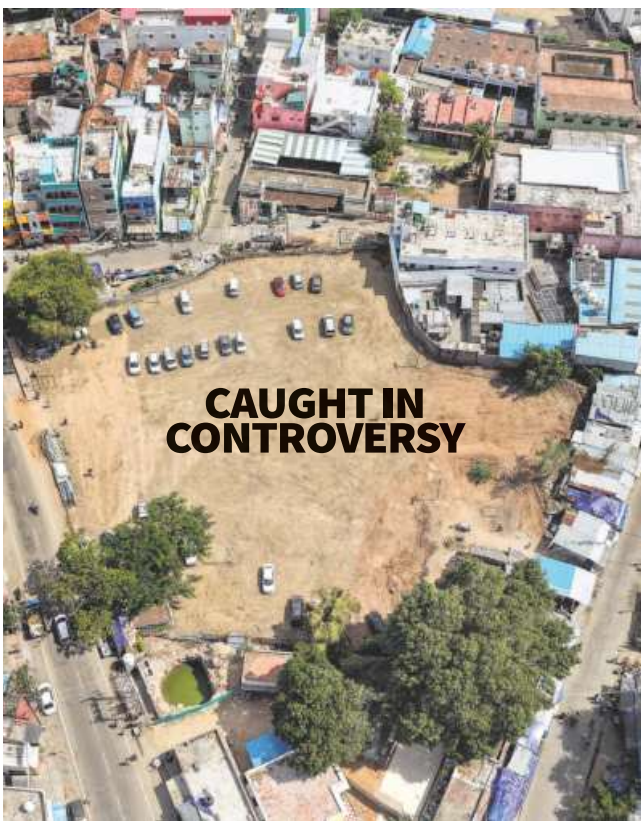
The flashpoint

On March 27, a sale deed was executed for ₹2 crore. After the issue moved from the police to the judiciary, the Tamil Nadu government ordered transfer of the case to the CB-CID. The Madurai Bench of the Madras High Court has since cancelled the registration.

Speaking to *The Hindu*, senior officials of the HR&CE, Registration, Police, and Revenue Departments said the persons behind the “deal” seemed to have utilised the loopholes in the law.

...fraud had been played and fraud has to be nipped in the bud failing which further innocent persons would only be misguided by the sale deed

MADURAI BENCH OF THE MADRAS HIGH COURT



The fraudulent registration of 1.40 acres of land belonging to Arulmigu Dhandapani Swamigal Madam at the foothills of Palani raised eyebrows. This is how the land deal happened:

March 27, 2026: Deed of Sale entered into between the vendor and purchasers	Commercial Taxes and Registration D. Logesh Tamilselvan acknowledges that there was a mistake on the part of the Sub-Registrar (in-charge) in registering the land, and a departmental inquiry has been initiated against him
April 1: The Sub-Registrar refuses to register the sale deed	
April 10: Single Judge of the Madurai Bench of the Madras High Court allows the petition filed by the purchasers and directs the Sub-Registrar to register the sale deed subject to the document being otherwise in order	
July 2: The Joint Commissioner, HR and CE, Palani, writes to the District Registrar asking that the land not be registered	
July 6: The document is registered by the Sub-Registrar (in-charge)	
July 13: The Palani Adivaram police register a case	
July 13: Sub-Registrar (in-charge) Justin Manikandan Subramanian placed under suspension	
July 14: Minister for	
	July 15: The probe transferred to the CB-CID from the Palani Adivaram police
	July 16: The CB-CID begins probe
	July 19: Former Minister for Commercial Taxes and Registration P. Moorthy questions how the transaction had been registered when the Registration Department had special markings for HR and CE temple lands that prohibited such transactions

For instance, the registration (according to the sale deed, a copy of which is with *The Hindu*) had been planned when the Model Code of Conduct for the 2026 Assembly election was in force. The election dates were announced on March 15 and the deed was executed on March 27, when all the political parties and officials were directly or indirectly busy with the election process. Hence, the needle of suspicion pointed to a few high ranking officials too.

Officials studying documents pertaining to the “deal” said the seller, M.D. Murugadass, son of Dhandapani Ayya of the Thirupugal Swamigal Murugadas Swamigal alias Dhandapani Swamigal Trust, had stated in the sale deed that he was authorised to sell the property in order to reinvest the proceeds for generating income to fulfil charitable objectives. He further said that through a public notice and bidding process, the purchasers – K. Vellaidurai of Tiruppur and D. Sethupathy of Dindigul – were chosen as the highest bidders. The seller had stated in the sale deed that the purchasers were informed about the cases pending in OS No. 358/2018 and OS No. 545/2016. Thereafter, they agreed to remit ₹2 crore, he added.

The current case

According to the document, it is said the property originally belonged to Thirupugal Swamigal Murugadas Swamigal alias Dhandapani Swamigal, who had created a private trust named Dhandapani Swami Madam for carrying out charitable activities from the income from the trust properties. The land forms part of the properties dedicated to the trust.

Further, the document said that after the demise of the earlier trustees, the trusteeship devolved upon successive trustees, including the father of the present vendor, Dhandapani Ayya, who administered the trust properties. The present vendor, being the lawful trustee, had been managing and administering the properties. As the property was not yielding sufficient income for carrying out the objectives of the trust, a resolution was passed on March 18, 2026 authorising its sale to reinvest the proceeds for generating income to fulfil the charitable objectives.

The vendor agreed to sell and the purchaser agreed to buy the scheduled property for ₹2 crore. The purchasers moved the Madurai Bench of the Madras High Court in April this year after the authorities refused to register the document. They presented a sale deed executed in their favour on March 27 for registration. However, the Sub-Registrar refused to register the sale deed.

The petitioners contended that the Sub-Registrar had no authority to adjudicate upon the question of title and mere pendency of civil suits could not be a ground for refusal of registration unless there was an order of restraint operating against them. A Single Judge Bench allowed the petition and directed the Sub-Registrar to register the sale deed, dated March 27, 2026, subject to

the document being otherwise in order.

In July 2026, the Arulmigu Dhandapani Swamigal Madam, represented by its *Thakkar*, preferred an appeal against this order. The appellant was not made a party to the writ petition before the Single Judge Bench. The court was informed that on the particular day when the regular officer was absent, the official in charge had registered the document. In response, the court said, “We are compelled to pass this order since fraud had been played and fraud has to be nipped in the bud failing which further innocent persons would only be misguided by the sale deed which had been registered by the registering authority”.

Further, the court said, “We are informed that the writ petitioners, while presenting the sale deed, had not even paid the requisite stamp duty and the sale deeds are therefore kept pending for want of sufficient stamp duty. This makes the situation all the more worse... They were however able to convince the Sub-Registrar to still register the document”.

The court declared the document void. “We take this extraordinary step to issue such a declaration in view of the fraud, which is evident at every stage of the process involved... The writ petitioners will have to suffer owing to their acts of fraud. Since we have declared the document void, we would refrain from imposing costs as we do not want the tainted money to flow further and cause further pollution,” it further said.

The accused in the case – the suspended Sub-Registrar (in-charge), Justin Manikandan Subramanian, and Vellaidurai – moved the High Court seeking anticipatory bail. According to Justin Manikandan, the document was originally presented for registration before the then Sub-Registrar, S. Balasundhar, on April 1. Meanwhile, District Registrar Sasikala was also placed under suspension.

The entire process of presentation of the document, admission of execution, obtaining signatures, and completion of all other statutory formalities had already been completed by the then Sub-Registrar on July 3. Justin Manikandan merely assigned the document number and forwarded the document to the Collector (Stamps), it was submitted.

However, the State said that though the document had been presented on July 3 and almost all the registration formalities had been completed by the then Sub-Registrar, the document had not been finally registered. It was Justin Manikandan who was in charge and completed the registration by assigning the registration number.

Given that the substantial part of the registration process had already been completed by the then Sub-Registrar and in order to balance the interests of the investigation and the liberty of the petitioner, the court granted interim protection to Justin Manikandan, conditionally, till August 4. But it dismissed the anticipatory bail petition filed by Vellaidurai.

The guideline value of the property is nearly ₹16 crore, whereas the vendor has hurriedly sold the property for ₹2 crore. This also raises serious doubts about the *bona fide* nature of the document. Allegations against the officers involved in the document registration and the trustees accused of having been paid ₹1 lakh in total for passing a resolution to sell the property should be investigated, the court said.

Under these circumstances, Palani Municipal Chairperson P. Uma Maheswari Pradheep filed a petition before the Madurai Bench seeking a Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) probe. The Registration Department has formed a committee to conduct an inquiry. The HR&CE Department has also constituted a committee to inspect the properties of the Palani temple and submit a report. CB-CID officers are conducting an investigation under the supervision of CB-CID Zonal Superintendent of Police Shajitha.

Temple property?

HR&CE Department officials said the property belonged to the temple and the administration had evicted encroachments following a court directive. However, the seller (Murugadass) claimed that he was the trustee of the property and had submitted evidence dating back to more than a century, the officials added.

Sources in the Registration Department said Justin Manikandan had given the approval for registration only after the High Court delivered its order. Some of the questions being raised are: If the land did not belong to the temple as claimed by the seller, why did the Madurai Bench cancel the registration and nullify the same? Secondly, if the land belonged to the Dhandayuthapani Swamy Temple, how did Sub-Registrar Justin Manikandan allow the *per se* illegal, high-value registration to happen in a day?

On July 14, Minister for Commercial Taxes and Registration D. Logesh Tamilselvan acknowledged that there was a mistake on the part of the Sub-Registrar (in-charge) in registering the land. Former DMK Minister P. Moorthy said the law is clear that temple or Waqf properties cannot be registered. How then did the registration take place, he asked.

‘Bigger conspiracy’

Hindu Munnani State leader Kadeswara Subramanian has demanded a CBI probe and described it as a mega land scam worth ₹100 crore. He said the Hindu Munnani would observe a fast at Palani on Sunday.

After the temple Superintendent (Land Section), S. Muruganantham, filed a complaint, the Palani Adivaram police registered a case on July 13. The complaint mentions that the value of the land is around ₹100 crore. Vishwa Hindu Parishad functionary D. Senthilkumar wondered how the land was registered for a mere ₹2 crore. “The officials had deliberately allowed the exchequer to suffer a huge revenue loss by way of stamp duty [assuming that the land belonged to private persons]. This raises the suspicion that this deal could not have happened without pressure from some highly influential person or persons,” he added.

Residents appeal to WRD to improve initial stretch of Thanikachalam Nagar drain

They say the work will reduce flooding in areas around Madhavaram and Retteri; while a major portion of the drain had been upgraded by the department, work on the initial portion is pending

CITY MATTERS

K. Lakshmi
CHENNAI

Residents of north Chennai have urged the Water Resources Department (WRD) to expedite the improvement of the initial stretch of the Thanikachalam Nagar drain to reduce flooding in areas around Madhavaram and Retteri.

While a major portion of the Thanikachalam drain, which carries surplus water from Kolathur and Retteri lakes, was upgraded last year at a cost of ₹91.36 crore, residents noted that the work on the initial 750-metre portion of the channel is pending. The channel is only 10 metres wide now and stormwater drains from various localities such as Ambattur and Korattur are also linked to



Awaiting nod: A detailed project report for widening the initial 750-metre stretch is awaiting government approval. B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

the channel, which finally flows into the Kodungaiyur drain.

‘Inadequate capacity’
T.K. Shanmugam, president, the Federation of North Chennai Residents Welfare Associations, said the inadequate carrying capacity has led to flooding in various wards of Madhavaram and Kolathur during heavy rainfall.

Pointing out that the encroachments have narrowed the surplus water channel, the federation has urged the department to build a cut and cover channel with a width of six metres to help alleviate flooding.

According to WRD officials, the Thanikachalam drain was built in 1998 and is nearly 3,050 metres long. It carries surplus wa-

ter from waterbodies in Retteri and Kolathur through localities such as United Colony, Ramalinga Colony, and Thanikachalam Nagar.

It flows into the Kodungaiyur drain that confluences into the north Buckingham canal.

Officials said the department had reconstructed the existing channel and also built an additional channel in the stretch between 750 metres and 3,050 metres. The carrying capacity of the channel was improved to 1,000 cubic feet per second.

A detailed project report for widening the initial 750-metre stretch is awaiting government approval. The WRD would coordinate with Revenue Department to demarcate the channel’s boundaries and remove encroachments to facilitate the project, the officials added.

Minister to inaugurate desilting drive tomorrow

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Water Resources Department (WRD) is set to begin desilting waterways in and around Chennai on Monday as part of its annual monsoon preparedness measures.

A press release said Minister for Water Resources and Rural Development N. Anand is likely to inaugurate the work.

Chennai has nearly 60 km of major waterways and water courses running for 54 km, besides water bodies spread across about 3,700 hectares in and around the city.

The exercise is aimed at reducing the risk of flooding during rainy days.

The work would be carried out in partnership with corporates, volunteers, and non-governmental organisations, and completed ahead of the northeast monsoon.

The Minister is scheduled to inspect works along the Cooum river and Okkiam Maduvu on Monday, according to the release.

GCC officials directed to strengthen source segregation of waste

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Greater Chennai Corporation Commissioner G.S. Saameeran on Saturday directed officials to strengthen source segregation of waste by ensuring that bulk waste generators separate biodegradable, non-biodegradable, sanitary and hazardous waste at the point of generation.

During a review meeting on solid waste management, He also instructed officials to continue public awareness campaigns on waste segregation, ensure

GCC Commissioner instructs officials to continue public awareness campaigns on waste segregation

scientific collection and recycling of construction and demolition waste, and enforce safe construction guidelines by imposing penalties on violators.

He called for accelerated biomining at the Kodungaiyur and Perungudi dump yards and intensified monitoring of solid waste management operations across the city.

Timings CHENNAI		
SUNDAY, JUL. 26		
RISE 05:54	SET 18:38	
RISE 16:15	SET 02:49	
MONDAY, JUL. 27		
RISE 05:54	SET 18:38	
RISE 17:05	SET 03:41	
TUESDAY, JUL. 28		
RISE 05:54	SET 18:37	
RISE 17:52	SET 04:34	

THE HINDU
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Kayalvizhi Alagiri booked for assaulting SBI branch manager

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Adyar police have registered a case against Kayalvizhi Alagiri, daughter of former Union Minister M.K. Alagiri, following a complaint by a senior State Bank of India (SBI) official alleging that the Manager of the bank’s NRI branch in Adyar was assaulted and threatened by the owner of the building housing the branch.

According to the complaint lodged on July 21 by Namachivayam, Chief Man-

The incident occurred after the Branch Manager informed Kayalvizhi about the need to repair a faulty lift in the building, which she owned

ager, SBI Regional Business Office-II, the Manager of the bank’s NRI branch in Adyar, Harshleen Singh, had informed the building owner, Kayalvizhi Alagiri, about the need to rectify a faulty lift after her representative alleg-

edly failed to respond to repeated requests.

The complaint alleged that an aggrieved Ms. Kayalvizhi subsequently visited the branch, abused the manager, assaulted him, and issued threats.

Based on the complaint, the police have registered a case under Sections 296(b) (uttering obscene words), 329(4) (penalty to house trespass), 115(2) (voluntarily causing hurt), and 351(2) (criminal intimidation) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita. Further investigation is on.

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INBRIEF



IGCAR event focuses on taking research innovations to space

The AIC IGCAR FAST Foundation (AIC FAST), the Atal Incubation Centre of Indira Gandhi Centre for Atomic Research (IGCAR), Kalpakkam, organised an event themed ‘Translation of IGCAR Technologies: From Lab to Land... and to Space’ on Friday. A press release said Myslwamy Annadurai, former Director of the U.R. Rao Satellite Centre, Indian Space Research Organisation, Bengaluru, spoke about the importance of synergy between the deeptech start-up ecosystem in the country and premier research and development centres such as IGCAR. Daniel Babu P., Head, Technology Transfer and Collaboration Division, Bhabha Atomic Research Centre, Mumbai, also spoke. Technology transfer licences for two IGCAR innovations were handed over to start-ups, and two scientific products developed under licences issued by the IGCAR were also launched.

More than 36 tonnes of waste lifted from 105 locations: GCC

The Greater Chennai Corporation (GCC) collected 36.64 metric tonnes of old household items, including furniture and clothes, from 105 locations across the city on Saturday. The discarded items were transported to the Kodungaiyur incineration facility and scientifically disposed of using 43 vehicles, a press release said. The weekly collection service, launched on October 11, 2025, is available on Saturdays. Residents can book collections through the *Namma Chennai* app, by calling the GCC helpline 1913, or by sending a message to the its WhatsApp number 94450 61913.

Metro Rail looks at building two more elevated corridors

CMRL plans to add Kilambakkam to Chengalpattu and Assisi Nagar to Wimco Nagar routes; consultant may be identified in three months

TRACK TALES
The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Chennai Metro Rail Limited (CMRL) will look at the feasibility of building two more corridors – Kilambakkam to Chengalpattu and Assisi Nagar to Wimco Nagar.

The Phase 1 network's corridor from Wimco Nagar to Chennai Airport will be further extended with this new proposal. As such, the CMRL has planned a southern expansion of this corridor and prepared a detailed project report (DPR) for the 15.46-km stretch from Chennai Airport to Kilambakkam, as it links the new bus terminus.

This DPR is currently being reviewed by the Centre for approval, after which the construction may begin.

According to CMRL officials, there are plans to extend the corridor further from Kilambakkam to Chengalpattu, covering a length of 26.9 km.

Additionally, the CMRL plans to link Wimco Nagar



The Phase 1 network's corridor from Wimco Nagar to Chennai Airport will be further extended with this new proposal. FILE PHOTO

with Assisi Nagar in Madhavaram – a key station in corridor 5 of the Phase 2 network (Madhavaram to Sholinganallur), creating another link between the Phase 1 and Phase 2 networks.

Both these networks are now connected through stations such as Alandur, Kilpauk, Thousand Lights, Nandanam, Koyambedu, and Vadapalani. The length of the Assisi Nagar-Wimco Nagar corridor will be 11 km.

“Since we have the road space and width, both Kilambakkam-Chengalpattu and Assisi Nagar-Wimco Nagar corridors will be

built as elevated stretches. We have floated bids for a consultant to prepare the DPRs for both corridors,” an official said.

The consultant is likely to be identified within three months, and the DPRs may be completed within four to five months. The cost estimate to prepare the DPRs is nearly ₹2 crore, the officials said.

The Comprehensive Mobility Plan states that the Airport-Chengalpattu and the Assisi Nagar-Wimco Nagar corridors are projected to reach Peak Hour Peak Direction Traffic of 12,471 and 10,647, respectively, by 2048.



HPCL officials at the launch of the lightweight and corrosion-free Navya cylinders in the city. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

HPCL, IOCL make available 5-kg, 10-kg composite cylinders

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

HP Gas customers in the city can now buy the more convenient composite liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) cylinders, as the company has launched the 5-kg and 10-kg variants for consumers.

Company sources said that initially, the lightweight and corrosion-free HP Navya cylinders will be made available in Kilpauk, Anna Nagar, Meenambakkam, and Velachery. “Consumers can see the quantum of cooking gas inside the cylinder. It is way lighter than the regular steel cylinders and can be handled easily by everyone. We will expand HP Navya to other areas in a phased manner,” a company official said.

Three agencies – Sri Ganesh Gas Service, Kilpauk; Annai Meenakshi, Anna Nagar; and Savitha Gas, Adambakkam – will stock

and deliver these variants.

Dharmendra Kumar Behura, General Manager – South Zone, LPG, HPCL, launched the cylinders at an event in the city. The company is likely to make them available via online delivery apps soon. At current prices, a 5-kg cylinder will cost ₹3,500 and a 10-kg cylinder ₹5,002.

Meanwhile, Indian Oil Corporation (IOCL) on Saturday launched express delivery of 5-kg and 10-kg LPG cylinders across the country, including Coimbatore. Indane XTRALITE NOW will come with express delivery service and minimal documentation.

Customers can register for new connections and book refills through the IndianOil ONE App and the IndianOil Customer website (<https://cx.indianoil.in>), with a WhatsApp (7588888824) booking facility to be introduced shortly.

Two college students drown in sea near Ennore

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A leisure trip to the beach ended in tragedy after two students of a private engineering college drowned while swimming off Bharathiyar Beach in Ennore on Saturday morning.

The deceased were identified as Keerthika, 19, a third-year Information Technology student from Puducherry, and Akash, 20, a second-year Electrical and Electronics Engineering student from Avadi.

According to the police, the victims, along with three of their friends from the private engineering college in Soorapattu of Tiruvallur district, had gone to the beach for a swim.

While swimming, Akash and Keerthika were dragged away by strong currents.

Fishermen rescued Keerthika and took her to a nearby hospital, where she was declared dead on arrival.

Personnel from the Fire and Rescue Services, with the assistance of local fishermen, launched a search for Akash. His body was recovered around three hours later and handed over to the police.

The bodies were sent to Government Stanley Medical College Hospital for a post-mortem examination. The Ennore police have registered a case.

City youth march to save marshlands

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Volunteers belonging to more than 30 youth organisations from across the city took part in a “March for the Marshlands”, as part of the Save Nemmeli Marshlands campaign, on Saturday.

A press release here said the organisations demanded that the State government stop the work to create the Mamallan reservoir and take steps to save other marshlands.

Narayanan, a fisherman from Kovalam, said the march was to remind the public that the Nemmeli marshlands were living ecosystems, not vacant land awaiting develop-



Ecological concerns: Volunteers belonging to over 30 youth organisations take part in the march held on Saturday.

ment. Destroying them in the name of climate resilience was morally indefensible, he said.

One of the organisers, Benisha B.M., said the proposed Mamallan reservoir was the defining test for the TVK government, which, she said, had neither halted

the project for an independent scientific review nor addressed concerns raised by ecologists, fisherfolk, and coastal scientists. Instead, the work had only been expedited.

Prashanth J., a wetland researcher, said: “It is fishing communities, Irulars,

Dalits, and other marginalised groups that bear the environmental and economic costs, while the benefits flow elsewhere.”

Kavya, a Class 12 student, said, “Successive governments have worked for corporations and elite interests while sacrificing the commons that sustain ordinary people. We refuse to inherit a city stripped of its wetlands, fisheries and resilience.”

Raju, an environmental activist, said that as long as governments force the poorest communities to surrender their lands and livelihoods for projects that mainly benefit the powerful, people are justified in calling it modern casteism disguised as development.

Minor held for death of ex-MLA's son

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A 17-year-old excavator driver was held for allegedly causing the death of the son of a former AIADMK MLA. The owner of the excavator was arrested for permitting the minor to operate it.

The deceased, Ulagadhipathi, 21, the son of P. Periyapullan alias Selvam from

Valayapatti in Melur taluk of Madurai district, was staying at a friend's house in Thiruvannamiyur. He was on the way to his college in Semmencherry on a motorcycle on July 22 morning, when the accident took place.

When he was riding the motorcycle near IIT-Madras on Sardar Patel Road, the excavator allegedly brushed against it from be-

hind. He fell from the vehicle in the impact, and was run over by the excavator, the police said.

The Mylapore Traffic Investigation Wing registered a case and questioned the 17-year-old who was driving the excavator. It found that the excavator owner, Rasakumar, 34, of Anna MGR Nagar, Pallikarantai, had allegedly allowed the minor to operate the heavy

vehicle, despite knowing that such vehicles should be driven only by trained and licensed operators.

Rasakumar was arrested and the excavator seized. He was produced before a court and remanded in judicial custody.

The juvenile was produced before the Juvenile Justice Board and admitted to a government observation home.

Experts bat for knee replacement tailored to each patient

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Modern knee replacement surgeries are about positioning the implant according to a patient's individual anatomy rather than relying on conventional mechanical alignment, experts at Parvathy Hospital said.

Vetri Kumar, Senior Consultant Orthopaedic Surgeon, said they performed total knee replacement procedures using the Evolution Medial-Pivot Knee System and a kinematic alignment approach. The implant preserves medial stability while allowing physiological rotational movement, with the aim of replicating the biomechanics of a healthy knee.

“Every knee is unique, and respecting individual anatomy can help achieve more natural and stable outcomes,” he added.

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OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

DEATH

OBITUARY


With profound grief, we regret to inform the passing off our beloved mother, **Smt. CHANDRA VISWANATHAN** Wife of Late **Shri K. M. Viswanathan**, Coimbatore on **22 July 2026** the cremation was held on **23 July 2026**. The rituals will be followed from the 9th day and performed from **30 July 2026** at Venkatesa Theertham, near Sai Baba Temple, Mylapore, Chennai.
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DEATH

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Raghupathy, Kalyaan, Sivakumar, Krishnakumar (Sons), Daughters-in-law, Grandchildren and their Spouses, Great Grandchildren
Dasasthu on Wednesday, 29th July 2026, at Gnanavapi, T.Nagar, Chennai.

DEATH

OBITUARY


Mr. V.VAIKUNTH, former Director General of Police, Tamilnadu - Officer Par Excellence and passionate Rotarian, passed away peacefully at his Bishop Garden residence on **10th July 2026**. A deep sense of gratitude to the Officers & men of the Tamilnadu Police, Rotarians from RC MCC, extended family, and friends who stood by us during this difficult time.
- Leela Vaikunth, Vijay, Arvind, Deepa & Chaitanya

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New traffic pattern near Dams Road leaves parts of Anna Salai choked

A new right turn towards Dams Road was enforced for vehicles coming from Periyar Statue side and Walajah Road, causing chaos; police promise to incorporate suggestions even as motorists demand a clear traffic management plan

STORIES FROM THE ROAD

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A section of Anna Salai choked with traffic on Saturday just ahead of the left turn towards Dams Road, after changes to the traffic pattern were implemented by police near Tarapore Towers without removing encroachments or installing the required traffic signals.

Traffic revision

Under the revised arrangement, vehicles heading towards Broadway via Anna Salai can either proceed through Dams Road-Blackers Road and rejoin Anna Salai, or continue straight along the arterial Anna Salai.



A long queue of vehicles was seen at the Buhari signal on Anna Salai as peak-hour traffic was hit by the changes. J. JOHAN SATHYADAS

The vehicles coming from Periyar Statue side and Walajah Road towards LIC were blocked near Buhari Hotel, as a new opening has been made for the vehicles to take a right towards Dams Road.

Srinivasan, a motorist coming from Broadway, said, “It is very difficult to cross the stretch as the police have blocked the flow of vehicles coming from Bata point and Walajah road junction during peak

hours and non-peak hours. Vehicles are lining up on Anna Salai from Anna Statue to G.P. Road junction.”

Karthikeyan, another motorist, said, “With the change in the traffic pattern, it is easier for the people coming from Spencer signal towards Anna statue and beyond, since two ways have been opened – one is straight on Anna Salai, and another is towards Dams Road and Blackers Road to reach Anna Salai. But the problem is that there is no proper traffic signal installed here for the vehicles coming from Bata point on the side of the roads to turn towards Dams Road.”

‘Need a clear plan’

Motorists have demanded a clear plan for managing traffic at the G.P. Road junction, the Anna Salai-

Dams Road junction, and the zebra crossing, and for a traffic signal to be established here.

A senior police officer of Greater Chennai City Traffic said, “We have introduced changes here for smooth traffic flow on Anna Salai and adjoining areas on a trial basis. After studying the flow of traffic and other factors, we may incorporate suggestions from the public and try to revive the system which existed a couple of years ago.”

“We deployed more personnel at the junction to regulate the traffic. Things may improve further, though initial hiccups cropped up. We are also constantly removing vehicles parked on the roadside near the restaurants and are issuing challans,” the officer added.

Protesters in city keen on continuing agitation, say NEET abolition is larger goal

Netika Francis
CHENNAI

As Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan tendered his resignation from the Cabinet on Saturday, protesters at the CPI State Office continued their demonstrations, now seeking the abolition of the National Eligibility-cum-Entrance Test (NEET).

Even as the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) announced its decision to withdraw the nationwide agitation, placards and speeches at the CPI’s office echoed the sentiment that Mr. Pradhan’s resignation was only the beginning.

Human rights activist and movement co-ordinator Thirumurugan Gandhi spoke to *The Hindu* about the goal of an extended protest. “While NEET abolition is the larger demand, we want exemption for Tamil Nadu from NEET,” he



Placards and speeches throughout the CPI’s office echoed that the resignation was only the beginning.

said. Those associated with the CJP were also keen on extending demonstrations. Isai Prakash, 32, CJP organiser, stated that the group’s withdrawal from agitation in Delhi did not mean that their tune would change in the South.

He said, “The [CJP’s] demand was met, they succeeded. It took 25 days to get the Education Minister to resign, we are willing to sit for 100 days, as long as the Centre gives the State

control over education,” he added.

In his speech, Mr. Gandhi discussed the idea of a change in venue so that more protestors can gather. “The Marina beach has hosted screenings of football matches and IPL matches, so why not now?” he asked.

“The party in power in Tamil Nadu agrees with the cause against NEET, so I don’t see why it should be an issue,” he said.



Breaking taboos: K. Jayalakshmi, 58, taking part in a Mandala workshop, along with other participants.

Multi-art workshops help city’s residents rediscover their self

Sahana Mira S.
CHENNAI

60-year-old B. Vijaya spent a weekend afternoon at the punch needle workshop, alongside other participants, in a room where tufting, crochet, pipe cleaner flower making, and six other workshops were happening all at once. Behind this curation was Shree Vidhyaa, who runs *Magizh* and has been conducting these multi-art workshops every month.

Diverse participants

“I quit my IT job to go all into art workshops. Many did not understand my desire to go all into art, but the Chennai crowd did not disappoint. People of all ages have been turning up to learn about different workshops under one roof,” Ms. Vidhyaa says.

For Ms. Vijaya, the workshops have been a way of finding her way back to a part of herself. She says she was not in touch with art for almost 20 years because of family commitments, but finally found a place where she could explore all kinds of art.

“I am probably the oldest in the room, yet I have caught up with current trends that the younger generation is into. I even learnt Thailand bag making, something I had never tried before. Earlier in those years, it was mostly knitting and glass painting, but now there’s just so much more to discover,” she says.

Me-time

Like her, a 58-year-old person with disability, K. Jayalakshmi, has made these multi-art workshops a monthly ritual, which she says, keep her whim-

sy alive as well as gets her uninterrupted me-time, attending two-three workshops at the space.

“I came for a journaling workshop and never stopped coming after that. I have learnt different kinds of art here, and the first thing I felt was that nobody judged what I created,” she says. And while the older demographic were getting in touch with the trends, the art facilitators themselves belong to the Gen-Z demographic.

Evolving art landscape

Maydhi R.C., who was teaching punch needle workshop to a group of people, said the art scene in Chennai has evolved over the years, and is now becoming a form of respite.

At another multi-art workshop and pop-up exhibit, Bauble Bazaar, run by Lekha Shree and Aaron since December 2023, you will find 20-plus workshops happening simultaneously, from moon catcher, sun catcher, Jupiter-gazing workshops to phone charm making and tufting.

“We have hosted 70-plus art-related workshops that are not the usual kind but something very new, such as a Saturn-gazing workshop with a telescope. More than the people coming to shop at the pop-up exhibit, we see parents bringing their children for the workshops, and that turns into a parent-child creating something together,” adds Ms. Lekha Shree. She says that apart from bringing people back to analogue and tactile experiences when everything is digital, it is about creating opportunities for women entrepreneurs and artistes.



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TRAINING & PLACEMENT ASSISTANCE
WALK-IN
GENERAL

GARMENTS

GARMENT EXPORT House Require Experience Senior Accounts Manager, Fabric Manager, Fashion Designers, Merchandisers, Admin Manager, CAD Technician & Operator. Office boy Good Salary. Send resume by mail to: adminmg700@gmail.com

GENERAL

DIPLOMA / Degree – Instrumentation / Mechanical / ECE, Male / Female – Exp / Freshers – For a Hi-Tech Entertainment Park in ECR. Salary no bar. Share CV or Ct : 87548 27479

REQUIRED EXP. Accountant Living in and around Anna Nagar. Salary no bar. Prefer immediate joiners. Ct: 98642 90094

GENERAL OFFICE Manager (M/F) Self-Driven, Computer Literate, Capable of Independently Handling Office Correspondence & Legal Agreements. VRS from Banks or other Industries Preferred. CV : devventureschennai@gmail.com

ASSISTANT MANAGER (Male) – Less than 40 years. For a Premium Banquet Hall in ECR, Candidates living in and around OMR / ECR / Adv Preferred. Ct: 99404 06479

Wanted Sales Staff For Titan Valspari & Valsarvkm Shwrm 20K Contact: 42135030/8754127164.

ISO CONSTRUCTION Company reqs 1) Freshers & with 0-2 yrs experience 2) Junior Engineer with 2-3 yrs experience 3) Project Engineer with 10-15 yrs experience 4) Planning Engineer with 5-10 yrs experience 5) Quantity Surveyor with 5-10 yrs experience 6) Electrician/IT Holder 7) Quality Controller with 3-5 yrs experience 8) Driver with Heavy Vehicle License. Send resume to: gbi@ganesanbuilders.in / hr@ganesanbuilders.in

T.NGR OFF. Admin,Accounts,Sales with Tally,Horti-Agri Supv, Office-Keeper. 9840821209/onzoneparta@gmail.com

Amana Gold Park Wanted Sales Man (Grt. Sales Asst. Computer Knowledge Digital Marketing. Priority will be given to North Chennai. Contact: 9444496464

WANTED HOUSE Keeping Person Male / Female Place: Avadi. Ct: 9789006335

ADMIN MANAGER / Accountant with Exp. Candidate (M/F) @ Velachery. Good Salary. 9789974898 / 9789974890

HIRING PART Time Job in & around Nanganallur Homemaker Career gap Retired, Age 35 above Call: 9840900599

PROJECTS / Marketing / Site Installation Engineers (Mech, Electrical or Chemical) Min 2 yrs Exp / Freshers / Intern apply for Trainees in Water treatment mfg Co. Mail: sales@perfectchloro.com Ph: 9840366309

GENERAL

FACTORY PROJECT @ Chennai Manali Req Supervisor Civil Er. 9884178443

LOGIWARE HIRING for Chennai. Warehouse Managers, Shift In charges, Supervisors, SAP Inventory Exe, Checkers with minimum 3yrs experience in Warehouse/Logistics Operations and knowledge in SAP & MS Office. Walk in Interview - July 26, 27, 28 Venue: The League Club Anna Sathya Nagar, Koyambedu, Chennai. Mob: 9947620614, 7593886101.

Chennai Port Authority No.1, Rajaji Salai, Chennai-600001

GENERAL ADMINISTRATION DEPARTMENT NOTICE INVITING APPLICATIONS FOR EMPANELMENT OF INQUIRY OFFICERS File No. A2/561/2026/GA

Chennai Port Authority, an autonomous body under the MoPS&W, Govt, invites applications from eligible retired officers of Major Ports/ Central Govt/ Central Autonomous Body/ Central PSU, preferably at the level of Dy. HODs and above of Major Ports and equivalent and having experience or knowledge of conducting inquiry proceedings as Inquiry officer. For full details regarding tenure, remuneration etc, please visit our website viz. www.chennaiport.gov.in Last date for receipt of applications is 08.09.2026.

Chennai-600001. SECRETARY

GENERAL

BANK OFFERS work from home 2L P.M Rtd.Nri,NRE,Auditors. 9841619586

REQ URGENTLY Diploma Civil Engineer& Account Asst with computer skills. Apply: trinitysquare25@gmail.com

WANTED-MARKETING Executive Leading IMFL & Beer Manuf. Company requires MBA/Any Deg. In all Districts.Ct.94459 06790 tnsalesteam26@gmail.com

Wanted Computer Teacher for Full time and Tamil Teacher for 10th Std Part time from Thiruvarkadu.81899 23555.

WANTED ACCOUNTANT M.Com., / MBA with 5+ Years Experience in Accounting & Taxation

ACCOUNT ASSISTANT B.Com., / M.Com., with 2+ Years Experience in Accounting & Taxation

DRAFTSMAN (CIVIL) Diploma in Civil Engg. with 3+ Years Experience in Construction Field.

RECEPTIONIST Any Degree with Minimum 3 years experience in Reception Role

OFFICE ASSISTANT 10th / +2. Should own a Two Wheeler

Mail Your Resume to: info@indiafoundations.com

Walk-In-Interview 29.07.2026 - Wednesday Between 11 am to 5 pm Venue : INDRA FOUNDATIONS PRIVATE LIMITED

54, 3rd Floor, Chevalur Shree Ganesh Salai, T Nagar, Chennai - 600 017. Mobile : 98412 95151

GENERAL

CHRISTIAN MEDICAL COLLEGE Ida Scudder Road, Vellore-4, TN.

SITUATION VACANT IN THE DEPARTMENT OF FINANCE AND ACCOUNTS

1. Manager (Finance and Accounts) Qualification: ACA/ACMA/ACCA/CPA/CIMA with over 12 years of post-qualification in Finance and Accounts of large organization and at least 5 years at senior level. Age Limit: Below 45 years

Salary: As per Institutional norms. Suitable experience may be considered for additional weightage of Salary.

2. Senior Manager (Finance and Accounts) Qualification: ACA/ACMA/ACCA/CPA/CIMA with over 15 years of post-qualification in Finance and Accounts of a large organization and at least 5 years at senior level. Age Limit: Below 55 years

Salary: As per Institutional norms. Suitable experience may be considered for additional weightage of Salary.

Job Profile: Experience in independently handling Accounts, Financial analysis, Taxation, Budgeting, Costing and Accounts finalization. Computer savvy. Health Care and NPO experience will be an added advantage. Salary will be As per Institutional rules

Apply on or before 15/08/2026. Applications should be made online in the CMC Website (https://clin.cmcvellore.ac.in/cmcappl/listapplication.aspx).

Application through other Job portal will not be considered and hard copies will not be accepted.

For clarifications, emails may be sent to gso2@cmcvellore.ac.in. No direct phone calls / personal appointments will be entertained. Shortlisted candidates alone will be informed of the Interview / Selection process.

THE HINDU

Classifieds SITUATIONS VACANT

Advertisement Rates The Hindu Chennai Edition

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Classifieds Display: Rs.1,435 per sqcm (Single Column)

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The above offers are available for The Hindu Chennai, Tamil Nadu, Southern and All Editions.

The advertisement copy will have to remain unchanged.

The advertisements booked under combo offers cannot be cancelled subsequently.

Terms & conditions apply.

For more details, please contact

Classifieds Customer Care

Phone: 044-28576342 Toll Free: 1800 102 4161

or Contact your nearest Authorised Space Sellers

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Classifieds Sunday & Wednesday Combo Offer:

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Classifieds Sunday, Wednesday & Friday Combo Offer:

At just 35% extra a Situations Vacant Advertisement in the Sunday Classifieds can be repeated under the same heading the following Wednesday and Friday in the Classifiedsmart columns.



GENERAL

WANTED LAWYERS for Drafting Work 1) Civil Law Experience Salary:50,000/- p.m. Apply to: office.al.legal@gmail.com

ANANYAKRISHNAA CONSTRUCTIONS requires Accountant (B.Com / M.Com with 6 years experience) Contact: 7092111155 Email: ananyakrishnaa@gmail.com

TOP BANKING Group Rqrs Mngrs & Distbtrs. Rtd/Hsws NRI Ct. 9176113474

WTD EXP Project Manager, Civil (Planning, QS), Mech, Ele, Safety, Environmental Engineers for Infra&Pipe line Projects apply vvvcp3@infra@gmail.com

ALFEX BUILDERS Walk-In: 26 & 27, 10am-5pm Min.3yrs Exp for Accounts/Admin, Site Supervisor, Ofc Asst. No.9, Old Bangaru Colony, 1st St, West K.K. Ngr. 7338854466/8939440606

HOTELS

WANTED RECEPTIONIST for Reputed Hotel in Avadi Chennai. Ct: 9808423447

HRD ADMIN

WANTED ADMIN. Exp. Manager Qual: Any Degree. Age below 40yrs. (Active & Trust Person only) Good Salary @ Kolathur Senthil Nagar. in & Around 15km. Ct:9629333000

MARKETING

MARKETING- EXP. Scientific Equipm Any Degree Good Eng/Hindi Will to Travel all over India.CH - 9677191916

MEDICAL

WANTED STUDIED Russian / Philippines Lady Doctor @ Velachery.8122640653

KEDAR HOSPITAL Mugalivakkam, Porur Req.Duty Doctors, RMO, Nurses, Ortho & Lab Technician & Accountant. Ct:Dr.Sridhar 9941022244, 9841332191

REQ 2YEARS Exp Bsc Qualified Water Chemist. Sal: 20000/- Ct:944021553

CIVIL ENGINEER and quantity surveyor. CT 9962179497

EXP/FRESH (F/M) : CAD Draftsman & Off.Asst Mr. Maduravoyal.80729 41139

WANTED SITE Engr BE / Dip. (Civil) / Site Supervisor / Office cum-Field Executive Male / Female Fresh or Exp/for a Reputed Construction Firm. Cont: 84389 16819 /98843 61260

WANTED CAD Civil Draftsman/ Fresh Interior Designers / Accountant with Excel, Tally, Exp 2yrs, Nr Chennai Central, Good Salary. 9444426748

IRCS CANCER HOSPITAL NELLORE WANTED MEDICAL ONCOLOGIST ELIGIBILITY : DM or DNB One Year Experience Telugu Knowledge is added Advantage Salary : Negotiable Contact : 0861-2341714 9392341714 cancerhospital2001@yahoo.in

TECHNICAL

REQ. CIVIL Engineer min 5-6 yrs exp: QS, Est&Billing; Site Mngmt, Const&Des Coordination; Dwg Check QC for Architecture firm in Besant Nagar. Exp in Civil, Str Steel, Interior&Fin works for Comm Res & Pvt Houses. Interested candidates pls send resume to: jobs@architectured.com

WANTED BE/DECE Min 4-5yr Exp in Const. 2yhr must 9841518845/7418486268

Required Engineer - DME Fresh/ Experienced Wire Rope Division for a company at Chennai. Ph: 9566119701

REQ 2YEARS Exp Bsc Qualified Water Chemist. Sal: 20000/- Ct:944021553

CIVIL ENGINEER and quantity surveyor. CT 9962179497

EXP/FRESH (F/M) : CAD Draftsman & Off.Asst Mr. Maduravoyal.80729 41139

WANTED SITE Engr BE / Dip. (Civil) / Site Supervisor / Office cum-Field Executive Male / Female Fresh or Exp/for a Reputed Construction Firm. Cont: 84389 16819 /98843 61260

WANTED CAD Civil Draftsman/ Fresh Interior Designers / Accountant with Excel, Tally, Exp 2yrs, Nr Chennai Central, Good Salary. 9444426748

REAL ESTATE

INDEX OF REAL ESTATE

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BUILDER'S REQUISITES
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BUILDING MATERIALS
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RESIDENTIAL FLAT-NEW
RESIDENTIAL FLAT-RESALE
RESIDENTIAL HOUSE
RESIDENTIAL LAND
TIME SHARE
GENERAL

BUYING

COMMERCIAL

WANTED 2 to 500 Acres @ Chennai & Tamilnadu. Owners Call : 9444033283

NEED COMMERCIAL Building in 1 Crore For Rental Income. Cnt: 8925119287

COMMERCIAL BUILDING

REQ BUDGET 10to100Cr Rental Income Building or Warehouse 9840055888

WANTED COMMERCIAL Rental income building Budget 3 to 25 Cr. 8438823345

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WANTED COMMERCIAL Rental income building Budget 3 to 25 Cr. 8438823345

COMMERCIAL BUILDING

GUINDY PRIME Office Space for Sale Fully furnished, Ready to move in 10 Grounds, 65,000 sqft of builtup Across 4flrs @ Mount Road, Basement parking, Ideal for Purchase/ Investment, Adjacent to Basahnam Business Park, Close to ITC Chola. Walkable to Little Mount & Metro Stations, Ct: 9673996609

OMR THORAIPAKKAM Opp ASV Towers 4Grd 3.50Cr/ Per Gr.Suit All Commercial Ct No: 98419 71947/ 6374 401 577

INDUSTRIAL SHED 8000 Sq Ft Sale in Ambattur Industrial Estate Near Wavin Bus Stop : 98848 09837

AVADI @ THIRUVANIPUR Bye Pass on Road Commercial Plots/2731sqft (11000sqft) Suitable for Petrol Bunk Kalyana Mandapam Tea Shop Office Godown&Jewellery Shop etc. Ct:9585958086

ON GUDUVANCHERY-NELLIKUPPAM Road 1.5 acre 170 frontage. Ct:9344364173

TNAGAR RANGANATHAN Street 6000 Sft (40x150) North Face Sale 8249425154

LAYOUT INVESTMENT Opportunity 3+ Acres in Singaperumal Kovil / Mahindra World City. 100% Secured Investment with very Good Returns.

90907 55000 COSMIC PROPERTIES

5 TO 25Acre Sale @Thiruvallur - Uttukottai State Highway. 10Acre Sale @Vengal - Sethanjeri Road 9282140409

PERUNGUDI NEHRU-NAGAR 40x60 3 Adj-joinPlots 30Cr Rd Southface 9500095421

MEDAVAKKAM LATHA Super Bazar Back Side CMDA(24x45) 1084Sft. 9489949914

2GROUNDS NEAR St.Antony Church, Manapakam Main Road. Suitable for Banks/ Poly Clinics/ Party Hall Etc. Cosmic Properties 9047734343

ECR MUTTUKADU on Main Rd 1Acre Appd. 1.70CrS Onwer Call Ct: 9677219352

TRIPLICANE 22008 & 5400Sft Suitabke-Showeroom, Lodge etc NoBrk 9310116843

PRIME COMMERCIAL Property's Sale in Chennai Ph: 9003073427 NO Broker.

KANCHEEPURAM AROTC & Bangalore on Main Road 54 Cent Sale. 944498866

THIRUKAZHUKUNDRAM On Main Road State Highway 25000sf Commercial Villa Plot Place Suit For Use 9840575139

THIRUPURUR MAIN ROAD OMR touch 1.25 Cents, 65 Lacs Resident& Commercial Purpose. 8825980426, 8428383537

NEAR MAMALLAPURAM Resident& Commercial 6 Cents 1.5 Crore OMR road touch available. 8825980426, 8428383537

BANGALORE HIWAY Sunguvachattam On Road Property 150Acre. 994558874

ANNA SALAI 10Gr Suit MSB Bid Show room Hospital Hotel NoBrk 7200033666

COMMERCIAL BUILDING

TAMBARAM WEST, Shanmugam Road 4500 Sqft Commercial Plot Ct: 9789689345

PORUR On Road Property 4.5 Grds. Per Ground Rs.3.5 Crs. Ct: 9940138111

COM.PLOTS SFT-1595&1689 @ Ayappaikkam-Rs.10000/- 9941665522/ 9805886663

WEST TAMBARAM - Mudichur Rd. 9000sf Commercial Land Sale. 9170228583

NUNGAMBAKKAM, STERLING Avenue, Prime Land Commercial / Residential, 3.4 Grounds. Only Direct Buyers. No Brokers, Contact : 9840327272

INDUSTRIAL WAREHOUSE Land 8250 square feet on 40 feet road Valapuram 50 cent in 33 feet road Valapuram 1 acre on 60 feet road Nayappakkam for Industries.ct : 9381093477

1-2ACRES ORAGADAM Periyasalayam Industrial Land Sale. 9150212072

40,800 Sq.Ft. Industrial Land with Existing Building For Sale at SIDCO Industrial Estate, Pattaravakkam, Ambattur, Chennai.

Prime Corner Plot with Road Access on Three Sides.

For enquiries, Contact: 9840837127

FARMHOUSE / LAND/ RESORTS

ECR MARAKKANAM Beach End Property 50Cent-3Acre 2.50L/Cent. 9944005933

ECR MUGAIYUR Opp Seaside 50Cent to 1Acre 1.25L/Cent Ct: 9944005933

Your feedback will keep us Cleaner, Sharper and Bolder

Call our toll-free number
1800 102 1878
Or write to us at
customercare@thehindu.co.in

Scan the QR code to register your feedback

THE HINDU

thehindubusinessline

FRONTLINE SPORTSTAR

कार्यालय अतिरिक्त मुख्य अभियन्ता, सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग, संभाग-बीकानेर
क्रमांक - 787
(DIPR/C/11007/26 Date 23-06-2026)
बिड सूचना संख्या 01 / 26-27 की निविदा संशोधन
दिनांक -22.07.2026

NIB CODE:- PWD2627A1210
इस कार्यालय के पत्रांक 527 दिनांक 16.06.2026 द्वारा जारी की गयी बिड सूचना संख्या 01/26-27, स्वीकृत कार्य (EPC MODE) की ऑनलाइन निविदा की दिनांक में निम्नानुसार संशोधन किया जाता है:-

क्र.सं.	मद	मूल निविदा में अधिकतम दिनांक	संशोधित दिनांक
1	बिड जमा करवाने / अपलोड करने की तारीख	22 जून 2026 प्रातः 9:30 बजे से 24 जुलाई 2026 को सायं 06:00 बजे तक	22 जून 2026 प्रातः 9:30 बजे से 13 अगस्त 2026 को सायं 06:00 बजे तक
2	बिड खोलने की तारीख	27 जुलाई 2026 को प्रातः 11:00 बजे	14 अगस्त 2026 को प्रातः 11:00 बजे

UBN Code No.- PWD2627WLCB05176
अतिरिक्त मुख्य अभियन्ता, शेष शर्तें पत्रांक में हैं।
DIPR/C/12940/2026

MSME TECHNOLOGY DEVELOPMENT CENTRE CHENNAI
Government of India Autonomous Body
CFTI, 65/1, G.S.T. Road, Guindy, Chennai - 600 032
2 Weekend Online Training Program on Government Certified Professional Course on Meta Ads & Social Media Expert
Date: 08th, 09th, 15th & 16th Aug. 2026 Time: 2.00 p.m. to 6.30. p.m.
Contents : What is Social Media, SMART Goals, KPIs & Target Audience, How Social Media Algorithms work, Choosing the Right Platforms + Policies, Introduction to Facebook – Organic Marketing, Why Business come to Facebook, FB Page Creation Checklist & Guidelines, Content Creation Planning for Facebook, Advanced Meta Ads, Type of Meta Ads, Meta Pixel in Facebook, Proven Campaign Strategy, Meta Ads Metrics & Formulas Guide, Custom Audience & Lookalike Audience, AI Fundamentals in Meta Ads, Meta AI Optimizes Ad Delivery, Ad Policies & Best Practices, Introduction to Instagram, The Instagram Algorithm 2025-2026, Reels Deep Dive + Type + Psychology, Reel Psychology, 5 Pillars of Instagram Growth, IG for Business, Business Profile Blueprint, DM: Strategy + Enquiry Funnel Business Instagram Checklist, IG for Personal Brand, Brand Identity + Follower Growth Monetization + Premium Positioning, Influencer Tiers, 8-Step Influencer Selection Framework, Type of Influencer Collaborations, 10 Common Mistakes Business Make with Influencers
COURSE FEE: Rs. 4,720/- (incl.GST)
Account No.: 39608074359, IFSC Code : SBIN000856, DIRECTOR, MSME TDC UPI ID : msmedtcdrfchennai
For Details Contact Ph : 044 22501529 Ext : 27 E-Mail: msmedtcdrfchennai.in www.cfichennai.in
GOVT OF INDIA CERTIFICATE WILL BE ISSUED TO SUCCESSFUL CANDIDATES

For Details Contact Ph : 044 22501529 Ext : 27 E-Mail: msmedtcdrfchennai.in www.cfichennai.in

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SARDAR VALLABHBHAI PATEL
International School of Textiles & Management
(Autonomous Institute under Ministry of Textiles, GOI)
1483, Avinashi Road, Peelamedu, Cbe-4. Ph: 0422-2571675, 7448827715

NOTICE INVITING TENDERS
Sealed tenders are invited from approved, reputed and eligible Solar Power Developers for the Design, Supply, Installation, Testing and Commissioning of 100 kWp Rooftop On-Grid Solar PV Power Plant at SVPISM, Coimbatore – 641 004. For the tender document and further details, visit www.svpistm.ac.in.
Last date for submission of tender: 14:00 Hrs on 17-08-2026.
- Director

NATIONAL HIGHWAYS AUTHORITY OF INDIA
(MINISTRY OF ROAD TRANSPORT & HIGHWAYS)

PUBLIC NOTICE ON REVISED USER FEE (TOLL) RATES AT VANAGARAM & SURAPATTU TOLL PLAZA APPLICABLE FROM 27.07.2026
The public are hereby informed that pursuant to approval of revised user fee rates vide letter dated 24.07.2026 of NHAI, the user fee rates for use of section from Km 0.000 to Km 19.170 in Chennai Bypass are going to be revised as under w.e.f.27.07.2026 (0.00Hrs) at **Vanagaram Toll Plaza** at Km 16.500 near Vanagaram Village Tiruvallur District in the state of Tamil Nadu.

Category of Vehicle	Fee for single Journey (Rs.)	Fee for Return Journey within a day (Rs.)	Fee for Monthly Pass for 50 single journeys in a month (Rs.)	Fee for single journey for the Commercial vehicles registered within the district of fee plaza (Rs.)
Car, Passenger, Van or Jeep	55	85	1860	30
Light Commercial Vehicles (LCV)	90	135	3005	45
Truck/ Bus	190	285	6290	95
Three – Axle commercial Vehicles	205	310	6865	105
Heavy Construction Machinery (HCM) or Earth Moving Equipment (EME) or Multi Axle Vehicle (MAV) (Four to Six Axles)	295	445	9865	150
Oversized Vehicles (Seven or More axles)	360	540	12010	180

The rates for monthly pass applicable for local non-commercial vehicle residing within distance of 20 km from the toll plaza shall be Rs. 360/- for the year 2026-27.

The public are hereby informed that pursuant to approval of revised user fee rates vide letter dated 24.07.2026 of NHAI, the user fee rates for use of section from Km 19.170 to Km 32.600 in Chennai Bypass are going to be revised as under w.e.f. 27.07.2026 (0.00Hrs) at **Surapattu Toll Plaza** at Km 28.600 near Surapattu Village Tiruvallur District in the state of Tamil Nadu.

Category of Vehicle	Fee for single Journey (Rs.)	Fee for Return Journey within a day (Rs.)	Fee for Monthly Pass for 50 single journeys in a month (Rs.)	Fee for single journey for the Commercial vehicles registered within the district of fee plaza (Rs.)
Car, Passenger, Van or Jeep	75	115	2580	40
Light Commercial Vehicles (LCV)	125	190	4170	65
Truck/ Bus	260	395	8735	130
Three – Axle commercial Vehicles	285	430	9530	145
Heavy Construction Machinery (HCM) or Earth Moving Equipment (EME) or Multi Axle Vehicle (MAV) (Four to Six Axles)	410	615	13700	205
Oversized Vehicles (Seven or More axles)	500	750	16680	250

The rates for monthly pass applicable for local non-commercial vehicle residing within distance of 20 km from the toll plaza shall be Rs. 360/- for the year 2026-27.

The following concessions are available at above toll plaza:

(i) Return Journey within 24 hours from time of payment for all categories of vehicles (discount 25%)
(ii) 50 single journeys in a month from date of payment for all categories of vehicles (discount 33%)
(iii) Pass at Rs. 360 per calendar month for non-commercial vehicle residing within 20 Km. from Toll Plaza
(iv) Commercial Vehicle (excluding those plying under national permit) registered in the District of Toll Plaza (discount 50%)
(v) Annual Pass can be purchased for Rs. 3,075/- through the "Rajmarg Yatra App" This pass is available for all Private Vehicle such as Cars, Jeeps and Vans (Non-commercial). This pass is valid for 1 year or 2000 plaza crossing whichever is earlier.

The list of exempted vehicles is as given in the Amendment to Fee Rules dated 03.12.2010 vide GSR 1950(E).

For viewing the fee notification published in the Gazette, letter of NHAI containing approval of rates, etc, the website <https://rajmargyatra.nhai.gov.in/> may be visited.

For any enquiry and / or giving complaints / suggestions, please contact: **The Project Director, National Highways Authority of India, Project Implementation Unit - Chennai - 2, Project Implementation Unit-Chennai - 2, Plot no.156, Srinivasan Street, Opposite Scope Global School (Landmark), G.G Nagar, Nerkundram, Chennai - 600 107.**

BUILDING A NATION, NOT JUST ROAD

बिहार सरकार

ROAD CONSTRUCTION DEPARTMENT
OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER, ROAD DIVISION, SUPAUL
Email ID:- eercdspl@gmail.com, Mob:- 9470001303
SBD BASED DETAILED NOTICE INVITING TENDER
(Through e-procurement mode only <https://www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in>)
NIT No.- RCD/04/SUPAUL/2026-27

1. Designation and Address of the Advertiser

2. Date Of Issue of Notice Inviting Tender

3. Period For Download of Tender Document

4. Date, Time & Place of Pre-Bid Meeting

5. Last Date & Time for Uploading Tender Document By Bidder

6. Date, Time & Place Of Opening Of Technical Bid

7. Details of Works:-

:- Executive Engineer, R.C.D., Road Division, Supaul

:- 24.07.2026

:- From 10.08.2026 to 17.08.2026 Up to 15:00 hrs. (From Website: <https://www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in>) Only.

:- 14.08.2026 at 11:00 hrs. At Office of The Chief Engineer, Simanchal Wing,Chhajubag, RCD, Bihar, Patna.

:- 18.08.2026 Up to 15:00 hrs. On Website: (<https://www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in>) Only.

:- Date - 18.08.2026 after 15:30 hrs. On Website : <https://www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in>

Group No.	Name of work	Estimated Cost (In Lakh)	Amount of Earnest money (Rs. in Lakh)	Cost of B.O.Q. (To be paid through online mode) (Non-refundable) (In Rs.)	Bid Processing Fee (To be paid through online mode) (Non-refundable) (In Rs.)	Time of completion of work (in months) Including monsoon period.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
1.	Widening and Strengthening of Majhari Chowk (NH-27) to Kunauli Bazar (Nepal Border) via Dagmara Road From Km 0.00 to 25.353	14424.52	154.24	10000.00	As appeared on e-proc2	18 Months

8. Date, Time & Place of opening of Financial Bid

9. Bid Validity

10. Any Contractor registered with the Central Government / Any State Government or Any PSU or an agency of international or national repute may participate in the tender but registration with the Road Construction Department, Bihar will be essential after issue of L.O.A and before executing the Agreement.

11. Detailed NIT can be seen on website <https://www.prd.bihar.gov.in> or the notice board of the office of the undersigned.

:- To be announced after approval of Technical Bid by Competent Authority (on Website : <https://www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in>)

:- 120 Days

For further details please visit website state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar

Executive Engineer
PR-008725(RCD) 2026-27

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RCD,Road Division Supaul

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INDEX OF RENTAL

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ACCOMMODATION WANTED-RESIDENTIAL

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CYK

A CH-CHE

Kerala govt. to revive police's Sabarimala clean-up project

Revanth bats for lowering age to contest elections to 21

Air Quality Color Key: Poor Moderate Good (Readings indicate average AQI)

SO₂: Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.

NO_x: Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.

CO: Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. It can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.

PM_{2.5} & PM₁₀: Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, cough, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease.

‘RSS and BJP are targeting basic structure of Constitution’

The event was organised by the Chinta Ravindran Foundation.

Karnataka Cabinet expansion talks likely to start this week

TDB to appoint new chief priest for Sabarimala temple

Kerala govt. giving in to Sangh agenda: Pinarayi on Waqf row



15 held in ₹22-lakh holiday package fraud in Hyderabad

Centre considering two new dry ports in A.P. and Telangana

Stone & spirit



“We will continue working closely with tech partners, drone operators, and AI specialists to accelerate innovation across our plantation business.”

Faster transfer

This initiative, undertaken in collaboration with technology partner Tropo-works, aims to streamline

From Page One

‘U.S.’s 10% tariffs will not affect 45% of exports’



India says it continues working with the U.S. government regarding textile exports. FILE PHOTO

The office of the U.S. Trade Representative (USTR) on Thursday released the final findings of its investigation on whether the U.S.’s trade partners were doing enough to prevent the import of goods made using forced labour. As a result of this investigation, it decided to levy a tariff of 10% on 17 economies, including India. While an additional five – the European Union, Taiwan, Japan, Korea, and Switzerland – will receive a lower effective tariff rate, the remaining 38 countries that were investigated will receive a higher tariff than India’s.

“The Government of India remained closely engaged with the USTR throughout the investigation through detailed written submissions and in-person consultations, including participation in public hearings,” the Ministry statement said, adding “as a result of these sustained efforts, India has been placed in the lower tier of additional tariffs under the final measures, providing a relative advantage to Indian exports in key sectors.”

‘Working with the U.S.’

In its report, the USTR also provided for the establishment of a “textile mechanism” in the form of tariff-rate quotas (TRQs) for Bangladesh, Cambodia, Indonesia, and Malaysia, to encourage these countries to import U.S. cotton and textile goods, “in order to reduce reliance on inputs from other sources that are more likely to contain forced labour inputs”.

India was not included in this mechanism, but India said it continues working with the U.S. government regarding India’s textile exports.

Highlighting that the textile specific mechanism referenced in the final measures “is yet to be established and operationalised,” the Ministry said, “India continues to engage with the U.S. on this matter as part of the ongoing negotiations for the India-U.S. Bilateral Trade Agreement (BTA).”

The government “remains committed” to working with the U.S. towards the early conclusion of the India-U.S. BTA, the Ministry said.

Maharashtra TET paper leak accused, aide held

The Maharashtra Special Task Force (STF) and the Special Investigation Team (SIT), which are probing the case, had raided the Quick Digital Cyber Cafe on Kachhari Road in Hajipur, Vaishali district, on July 1. Three individuals, including cafe operator Sonu Kumar, were taken into custody and questioned. The investigation also established a link between Sonu Kumar and Gupta.

Sources in the Hajipur police said that Kumar’s confession led to the arrest of a cyber cafe operator in Hajipur. Earlier, the police had also arrested Pawan Kumar from Delhi and Hariom Panu from Haryana—close associates of Gupta.

Earlier, a team comprising the Bihar STF and the Bhiwandi police from Maharashtra’s Thane district had arrested Gupta’s wife, Suman Kumari, from Patna’s Agamkuan area on July 1, based on her call records and financial transactions.

Union govt. circulates Bill to strengthen anti-cheating law

Centre to introduce the Bill in Parliament on Monday; it proposes to introduce mandatory two-month investigation deadlines, designated Special Fast Track Courts, steep financial penalties

Maitri Porecha
NEW DELHI

In a move to strengthen the anti-cheating law, the Union government has proposed the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Amendment Bill, 2026, a copy of which was circulated among members of Parliament on Saturday.

Union Minister Dr. Jitendra Singh will introduce the Bill in the Lok Sabha on Monday.

The proposed legislation significantly toughens the penalties established under the 2024 Act, introduces mandatory two-month investigation deadlines, along with designated Special Fast Track Courts, and steep financial penalties reaching up to ₹10 crore for organised crime networks.

Maximum imprisonment sentences for individual and institutional offenders have been increased, alongside a steep hike in financial penalties, according to the proposed Bill.

Specialised Enforcement Units enable the Un-

Tougher rules, bigger fines

The Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Amendment Bill, 2026 significantly escalates the cost of committing or facilitating exam malpractices

■ Under Section 10(1) (General offences): Jail: 5-10 years (from 3-5 years); Fine: up to ₹50 lakh (from ₹10 lakh) ■ Under Section 10(2) (Service provider fines): Fine: up to ₹5 crore (from ₹1 crore) ■ Under Section 10(2) (Service provider directors/management): Jail: 3-10 years;	Fine: ₹5 crore (from ₹1 crore) ■ Under Section 10(3) (In-charge personnel): Jail: 5-10 years (from 3-10 years); Fine: ₹5 crore (from ₹1 crore) ■ Under Section 11(1) (Organised crime): Minimum jail: 7 years (from 5 years); Fine: up to ₹10 crore (from ₹1 crore)
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ion government to constitute dedicated Special Task Forces (STF) to take exclusive charge of investigation efforts.

All investigations – whether conducted by local police, Central Investigating Agencies, or an STF – must be concluded within 60 days.

State governments and Union Territory administrations will designate Sessions Courts to conduct trials on a continuous, day-to-day basis. Trials must wrap up within three months of the chargesheet being filed. High Court appeals will be heard by a Di-

vision Bench (two judges) and must also be resolved within a three-month period.

To address prolonged legal delays, the Bill introduces Sections 12A and 12B, establishing an uninterrupted procedural pipeline.

Courts cannot grant adjournments beyond the following day without writing explicit, exceptional reasons.

Transfer of cases

All ongoing cases under the 2024 Act will immediately transfer to the newly designated Special Fast

Track Courts and must be completed within three months of transfer.

States and Union Territories are mandated to appoint Special Public Prosecutors under the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS), 2023 to handle these trials exclusively.

Appeals against bail orders, judgments, or sentences must be filed within 30 days (with a strict absolute ceiling of 90 days for special delays) and will be adjudicated by a two-judge High Court Bench.

Recent incidents of paper leaks and malpractices have necessitated urgent structural overhauls to safeguard transparent and merit-based selections.

“The objective of the Act is to bring greater transparency, fairness, and credibility, and to inspire confidence in the public examination system, Dr. Jitendra Singh noted.

“The amendments ensure time-bound investigations, speedy trials, and enhanced deterrence against organised crime groups and institutions,” he said.

FIR registered on Goyal’s complaint over deepfake video

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI



Piyush Goyal

Union Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal on Saturday alleged that an AI-generated deepfake video had “maliciously” altered his remarks to the media outside Parliament to spread misinformation, and said he had lodged a police complaint, following which an FIR was registered at the Chanakya-puri police station.

In a post on X, Mr. Goyal said the manipulated clip was being circulated on social media with the intent to mislead the public and warned that “strict legal action” would be taken against those involved in creating, disseminating or promoting it.

He also asserted that irresponsible misuse of artificial intelligence to mislead the public cannot and will not be tolerated.

Government sources said many social media links carrying the AI-generated video had since been taken down.

The PIB’s fact-check unit had on Friday said Pakistani propaganda accounts were circulating the fabricated video, which falsely

portrayed Mr. Goyal as making threatening remarks against students protesting over alleged irregularities in NEET. Mr. Goyal urged the public to rely only on verified sources of information. “I have complete faith that India’s aware and tech-savvy citizens, especially our youth, will not fall prey to such misinformation,” he said.

The manipulated video surfaced against the backdrop of the recently concluded student protests organised by the Cockroach Janata Party at Jantar Mantar, New Delhi. Social media has witnessed a surge in content related to the demonstrations, and authorities have repeatedly cautioned users against relying on unverified videos and posts circulating online.

Great Nicobar project ‘most fundamentally a commercial enterprise’: Jairam Ramesh

Jacob Koshy
NEW DELHI

In his latest letter, Congress MP Jairam Ramesh has rejected Defence Minister Rajnath Singh’s contention that the Great Nicobar Island Project is a strategically vital national initiative. He reiterated that the scheme is “most fundamentally a commercial enterprise” for which a strategic rationale is being “invented.”

Mr. Ramesh was responding to Mr. Singh’s reply of July 17, which had itself answered two of the MP’s earlier letters.

Over the last two years, Mr. Ramesh has written repeatedly on the project to four Union Ministers – Environment, Forests and Climate Change; Tribal Affairs; Ports, Shipping and Waterways; and Defence – three of whom, he said,



Jairam Ramesh

have replied.

In the recent letter, Mr. Ramesh argued that the trans-shipment port at Galathea Bay lay at the project’s heart and accounted for about half its budget, making it commercial “by definition.” The dual-purpose airport, the only component with a defence focus, required just 5% of the 166 sq. km sought and about 10% of the budget, he said, calling claims of the project’s overall strategic importance an “exag-

geration.” He added that the Draft Master Plan for 2047 envisaged cruise tourism, casinos, theme parks and a finance hub, reading “more like an ambitious real estate project.”

Mr. Ramesh also reiterated that expanding the existing INS Baaz at Campbell Bay would carry lower environmental and social costs than the greenfield airport, citing seven concerns – among them the felling of two forest-covered hills, destruction of Shompen tribal land and impacts on international bird flyways – that he said remained unrefuted. He questioned the confidentiality of the National Green Tribunal (NGT)-appointed High-Powered Committee report and urged the Minister to consult retired naval officers who have questioned the defence reasoning.

Families must connect with the youth through dialogue, not dictation, says RSS chief

Ishita Mishra
NEW DELHI

Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS) chief Mohan Bhagwat on Friday stressed that the biggest challenge before families today is connecting with the younger generation through dialogue rather than authority, asserting that “today’s youth need discussion, not dictation.”

Mr. Bhagwat was speaking at an event organised under the banner of Vishwa Mangalya Sabha, an organisation “focused on empowered motherhood, cultural harmony and universal wellbeing”, as per its website.

The event took place at Ambedkar International Centre, just a kilometre away from Jantar Mantar, where students were protesting against exam paper leaks under the banner of



Mohan Bhagwat

the Cockroach Janta Party. In his speech, the RSS chief stressed that parenting styles must evolve with changing times.

“There was a time when obedience came naturally. When we were children, if our mother or father said something, there were no arguments. Once they had spoken, that was the end of the discussion. We also had deep faith in them. We believed they had seen more of life than we had, and that their experience

would guide us in the right direction,” he said.

Stressing how things are different presently, he added, “The younger generation asks questions, and rightly so. They are constantly exposed to countless influences through modern media and materialistic culture, which often leaves them confused. It is our responsibility to help them find clarity amidst that confusion.”

He said that children need a strong sense of belonging. “Today, parenting has to be about discussion; not orders, but consensus,” he said.

Stating that children today judge parents by their actions and not directions, he said that the younger generation won’t accept things simply because they’re told about them. They want ‘us’ to practise what we preach, he added.

Sarnath added to UNESCO Heritage List

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

India’s ancient Buddhist site of Sarnath in Uttar Pradesh was on Saturday inscribed on the UNESCO World Heritage List. The decision was taken during the ongoing meeting of the UNESCO World Heritage Committee’s 48th session in Busan, South Korea.

“New inscription on the @UNESCO #WorldHeritage List: Ancient Buddhist Site of Sarnath, #India,” UNESCO posted on X. This is India’s 45th site to join the list.

PM Narendra Modi hailed the inscription, stating that the site has a deep connection with Lord Buddha, whose timeless message of wisdom, compassion, and harmony inspires the world.

After 12 years in power, Dharmendra Pradhan’s exit exposes BJP’s shrinking political legroom

NEWS ANALYSIS

Nistula Hebbar
NEW DELHI

The resignation of Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan, a demand sustained over long weeks by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) and young protesters, is not the first instance of a Minister resigning from the Narendra Modi government, nor is it the first time this government has blinked in the face of a strong protest movement.

The Union government under Mr. Modi walked back on the Right to Fair Compensation and Transparency in Land Acquisition, Rehabilitation and Resettlement (Amendment) Ordinance in 2015, after repromulgating it thrice. Former Minister of



CJP supporters celebrate as Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan resigns, at Jantar Mantar, on Saturday. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

State for External Affairs M.J. Akbar resigned in 2018 after allegations were levelled against him in the #MeToo movement. The Farm Laws were withdrawn after months of protests by farmers at Delhi’s doorstep in 2021. Mr. Pradhan’s resignation may be seen as a part of this series of reversals. On the

other hand, the government carried the day in other protests, including by the students of the Jawaharlal Nehru University here in 2016, and the widespread protests against the Citizenship Amendment Act in 2019-2020, in which the polarisation suited the BJP’s base. All of this is, of course, a product of

political calculations, of whether the government feels it can remain strong on its point or whether it needs to concede now to live to fight another day.

Challenge for the govt.

The CJP-led protests have been a political challenge for the Modi government, now in its 12th year. The protesters are young citizens, and they cut across lines of caste, community, and even class. Many could also have hailed from families that may have voted for Mr. Modi in successive Lok Sabha elections.

The protests also bring to the fore another reality. Gen Z, as they are termed, are now in their late teens and early 20s and were children when Mr. Modi assumed power. They do not recall the acts of omission and commission by previous governments, and in-

stead want a response to the way things are run now, and have been in the past 12 years.

Every government takes decisions based on its own political calculations. What should not be part of that calculation is obduracy over whether a Minister will stay or go, or whether or not genuine demands by embattled students should be met.

In this, the 12th year and the third iteration of a BJP-led government, the Modi government has very limited legroom and manoeuvrability for taking political risks in events such as the CJP protests. Young protesters have shown the government that a new cohort of leaders and voters is nipping at its heels. To engage with them, the government may have to shake its 12-year-old playbook.

Ex-Chhattisgarh PSC chief arrested in paper leak case

Press Trust of India
RAIPUR

The Enforcement Directorate on Saturday arrested former Chhattisgarh Public Service Commission (PSC) chairman Taman Singh Sonwani here on money laundering charges in an alleged examination paper leak case, officials said.

The probe pertains to the “leak” of question papers and “manipulation” of the State service examinations conducted in 2020 and 2021 by the Chhattisgarh Public Service Commission. Officials said Mr. Sonwani was taken into custody under the provisions of the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA).

He is being produced before a special PMLA

court in Raipur, where the ED will seek his custodial remand, an official said.

The money laundering investigation stems from a 2024 Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) FIR. The CBI case was booked based on a State police complaint that was filed after the BJP came to power in Chhattisgarh. He was arrested in 2024. The ED accused Mr. Sonwani of leaking question papers and rigging selections in exchange for illegal gratification favouring his own relatives and candidates who paid bribes. The probe found that “bribes” were collected partly in cash and partly laundered through a family-controlled “samiti” in the guise of CSR donation for a “non-existent” college.

INBRIEF



Amarnath Yatra resumes in J&K amid inclement weather

Amid the inclement weather, the Amarnath Yatra resumed from the Baltal Axis in central Kashmir on Saturday after a six-day halt. The Yatra also resumed at the Mata Vaishno Devi temple in Jammu. Officials said a batch of 6,269 pilgrims arrived at the Baltal base camp in Kashmir in a convoy of 223 vehicles. “Due to the recent rains, urgent repair and maintenance works are required to be carried out on the Pahalgam Axis of Shri Amarnathji Yatra. The Yatra shall continue through the Baltal Axis, for which adequate arrangements have been put in place to ensure a smooth and safe pilgrimage,” Divisional Commissioner of Kashmir, Anshul Garg, said.

Punjab Police secure fugitive gangster’s deportation

Punjab’s Anti-Gangster Task Force, in coordination with the central agencies, has successfully secured the deportation of a fugitive gangster from Jakarta after a six-month-long manhunt, police said on Saturday. DGP Gaurav Yadav said Jobanjit Singh is wanted in multiple heinous criminal cases, including murder, attempt to murder, Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances Act and Arms Act offences. “The operation marks the successful culmination of Operation Nomad Hunt, a six-month-long intelligence-led international manhunt involving sustained surveillance,” Mr. Yadav said on X. PTI

Rajasthan on alert after deaths linked to Chandipura virus

Rajasthan’s health department has intensified surveillance and stepped up vector-control measures in Dungarpur, Sirohi and adjoining areas after reports confirmed that two girls from the state, who died while undergoing treatment in Gujarat, had tested positive for the Chandipura virus (CHPV). The deceased include a six-year-old girl from Ratanpura village in Dungarpur district and a two-year-old girl from Sirohi district. Chandipura virus is an emerging vector-borne pathogen that primarily affects children aged below 15. It causes fever, flu-like symptoms and acute encephalitis, and is transmitted by vectors such as mosquitoes, ticks and sandflies. PTI

Assam Police arrest 3 linked to Pak.-based terror network

The Assam Police have unearthed a terror module linked to Pakistan-based Shahzad Bhatti network and arrested three alleged operatives in the State, an official said on Saturday. The official said the Special Task Force (STF) conducted a coordinated operation on Friday with assistance from the district police of Dhubri, Chirang, and Barpeta. STF Senior Superintendent of Police Pranab Kumar Pegu said, “The Pakistan-based terrorist-criminal network is allegedly involved in recruitment, online radicalisation, espionage, illegal procurement of arms, establishment of sleeper cells and facilitation of terrorist activities in different parts of the country.” PTI

SUDOKU

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		8	4			1		
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DIFFICULTY RATING: ★★★★★

Solution to yesterday’s Sudoku

7	5	9	1	2	8	3	6	4
6	8	4	5	7	3	9	2	1
1	3	2	4	9	6	5	7	8
2	9	1	6	8	7	4	5	3
8	6	3	2	4	5	7	1	9
4	7	5	9	3	1	6	8	2
3	2	6	8	5	9	1	4	7
9	1	8	7	6	4	2	3	5
5	4	7	3	1	2	8	9	6

Urban food habits rewriting gut microbiome in India, says study

Study finds links between urban diets and gut microbiomes that could be reason behind rising diabetes rates in India; as of 2024, India has about 89.8 million adults living with diabetes, even as an estimated 43% of cases currently go undiagnosed

Jacob Koshy
NEW DELHI

Bacteria in the human gut, and not just genes, may help explain why urbanising Indians face rising rates of diabetes, obesity and hypertension. This is from a three-year study that has produced what its authors describe as the first reference database of the gut microbiome across South Asia.

The study, published in the peer-reviewed *Gut Microbes*, sampled 575 adults from 10 communities across India and Sri Lanka and profiled their gut bacteria through gene. Niraj Rai of the Birbal Sahni Institute of Palaeosciences, Lucknow, who led the work with Maanasa Raghavan of the University of Chicago, said India offered a rare natural experiment. “India is the only country where you can still find a rural versus urban” population that shares ancestry



Access to processed food is the reason behind differences in gut bacteria of city dwellers and their rural relatives, says study. REUTERS

but lives in very different food environments, he said.

India has an estimated 89.8 million adults living with diabetes as of 2024, according to the International Diabetes Federation’s latest data. This is the second-largest burden in the world after China, and roughly one in every seven adults with the disease globally.

The federation projects India’s total will climb about 75% to reach 156.7

million by 2050, even as an estimated 43% of cases currently go undiagnosed. Worldwide, 589 million adults are estimated to have diabetes. The disease’s steep rise in India has been driven in large part by rapid urbanisation and dietary change – the very transition this study set out to read in the gut.

The researchers designed their study by pairing each remote, forest-dwelling or early-agriculturalist community with

relatives who had migrated to towns and cities with access to processed food – “pizza, chowmein, coke,” in Mr. Rai’s description. Because both groups share genetic ancestry, verified by genome sequencing, he argued that differences in their microbiomes must stem from environment rather than genes.

Sri Lanka’s Vedda, among the region’s oldest hunter-gatherer settlers, were included because they remain genetically South Asian while retaining a foraging lifestyle that Mr. Rai said approximates an “ancient gut signature.”

Urban-rural bacteria

The clearest example of environment reshaping the same genetics is *Megamonas*, a bacterium the study found consistently more abundant in urban individuals than in their rural kin. Megamonas has been linked worldwide to obesity, hypertension and raised blood glucose. “We

are reporting for the first time that Megamonas are thriving because of change in diet,” Mr. Rai said.

Running the other way is *Holdemanella*, associated with fibre intake and glucose tolerance, prevalent in South Asia but apparently lost with urbanisation – except in Kerala, Mr. Rai noted, where communities largely kept traditional diets even after migrating.

Mr. Rai framed urbanisation as a matter of food processing rather than meat-eating. In the north-east, he said, rural and urban communities both eat meat; the urban difference is the biscuit, soft drink, and occasional pizza.

The project is now moving to a functional phase. Mr. Rai’s team has begun metabolomics – profiling the molecules these bacteria produce – to connect specific microbes to specific diseases. By year’s end, he expects roughly 1,000 samples.

Gujarat floods: toll rises to 35 as floodwaters recede; damage surveys begin

Abhinav Deshpande
AHMEDABAD



Truck drivers wade through a flooded road after their vehicles got stuck following heavy rainfall in Ahmedabad on Saturday. PTI

The death toll from rain-related incidents in Gujarat has risen to 35 over the past two days, with authorities recovering bodies after floodwaters receded and rescue operations concluded, Relief Commissioner Gaurang Makwana said on Saturday.

Most of the fatalities occurred due to drowning or people being swept away by strong currents. Of the total deaths, 29 were reported from the worst-affected districts of Navsari and Valsad.

With rainfall easing across the State, the administration has shifted its focus to post-flood restoration. Authorities have begun assessing damage to crops, houses and public infrastructure, besides undertaking cleaning drives and pesticide spraying to prevent the spread of water-borne diseases.

More than 7,000 people

were rescued during the recent spell of heavy rain, with the highest number of rescue operations carried out in Navsari and Surat districts. Over 42,000 residents were relocated to safer places, Mr. Makwana said.

The State deployed 18 teams of the National Disaster Response Force (NDRF) and 32 teams of the State Disaster Response Force, supported by the Indian Army, Coast Guard and local volunteers.

Valsad District Collector Nitin Sangwan said damage assessment surveys

had begun. Financial assistance for affected residents, including compensation for wage losses of up to three days, damaged household items, and livestock deaths, will be disbursed from Monday.

Red alert

The India Meteorological Department (IMD) issued a red alert on Saturday for Banaskantha, Patan, Surendranagar, Mehsana, Kheda, Aravalli and Sabarkantha districts, while an orange alert has been forecast for some of these districts on Sunday.

Enemy intentions remain unchanged, proxy war still a challenge, says Rajnath

Peerzada Ashiq
SRINAGAR



Rajnath Singh presents a memento to a relative of a martyr during Vijay Diwas celebrations at the Kargil War Memorial on Saturday. PTI

Union Defence Minister Rajnath Singh, who toured Jammu & Kashmir and Ladakh’s Drass on Saturday, said the intentions of the enemies have not changed and the proxy war still remains a security challenge in the region.

Without naming Pakistan, Mr. Singh, while speaking at Shaurya Bhoj in Drass, said, “As we celebrate the Kargil war victory, we have to remind ourselves of the challenges. The intention of our enemy remains the same. Proxy war is still used as a tactic. Our Army is ready to foil these nefarious designs.”

The Defence Minister arrived in Srinagar on Saturday morning on a two-day tour of the region. He was received by J&K Lieutenant-Governor Manoj Sinha. Officials said they discussed the current security situation in J&K, especially

in the wake of the Anantnag attack that left one policeman dead three days ago.

Later, Mr. Singh visited the war memorial at Ladakh’s Drass on the eve of 27th Kargil Vijay Diwas. He paid tributes to the soldiers who laid down their lives in the line of duty in the 1999 Kargil War, as he attended the ‘Shaurya Sandhya’.

“It’s these sacrifices that make people of India feel safe. When oxygen levels dropped in 1999, the guns of our soldiers did not fall

silent till the Tricolour was unfurled as a mark of victory,” said Mr. Singh.

Ten families of Kargil War bravehearts were also felicitated on the occasion. Commemorative events were held at ‘Yudh Sansmaran’ at Lamochen View Point, where Kargil War veterans and families of fallen soldiers remembered the sacrifices made during Operation Vijay.

A documentary and special presentations highlighting the valour of 40 war heroes were screened during the event.

Why are mega data centre projects facing stiff resistance?

EXPLAINER

Paul Nicodemus
Snehal Mutha

This week, people in Andhra Pradesh and Maharashtra took to the streets to oppose the proposed mega data centre projects in the States.

In A.P., after the government allotted about 601 acres of land across three locations in Visakhapatnam and Anakapalli district, Raiden Infotech India Pvt. Ltd. – a Google company – began developing a IGW AI data centre hub, with Adani Infra/Adani-ConneX as the notified development partner.

In Maharashtra, residents of Thane have been opposing Amazon’s proposed hyperscale data centre project. The ₹7,203.29-crore project spread over 53.73 acres is under construction across

the villages of Balkum Pada and Majiwada in Thane.

Reasons for opposition Citizens’ groups in Visakhapatnam have opposed the Andhra project, highlighting concerns over the strain on resources such as water and power, as well as its environmental impact. The project is coming up at three locations – Adavivaram-Mudasarlova, Tarluvada, and Rambilli.

Campaigners also cited that the Super El Niño-like weather pattern has put strain on water resources across the State.

In Thane, people have cited sketchy details, discrepancies in water usage data, lack of consultation with locals as reasons to rally against the project.

Residents represented by the citizen group ‘Wakeup Thanekar’ has demanded clarity on the water usage and a public hearing. It has sought the



Citizen groups hold a protest against proposed data centre projects in and around Visakhapatnam, along Beach Road on July 19. V. RAJU

establishment of baseline noise and air quality measurements, and a clarity on the actual benefit to locals.

The opposition from citizens was not to technology or investment but to a project that offered little in return for its costs, said Sohan Hatangadi, a campaigner in Visakhapatnam. He cited limited permanent employment and limited ancillary industry, even as the city provides

land and incentives.

President of Green Visakh, Raja Rama Mohan Roy, said the project risked the “reckless exploitation of nature”. He said the Kambalakonda Eco-Forest, and the surroundings of the Rambilli Wildlife Sanctuary faced a threat, along with the Mudasarlova reservoir, a source of drinking water for the city.

In Thane, activists are against “unplanned deve-

lopment”. “We cannot have the data centre in residential area, which are already suffering water shortage, load shedding, and other issues,” Sadhana Pradhan, convener of Wake-up Thanekar said.

The group plans to file a petition with the National Green Tribunal after the government response. It had held a meeting with the Thane municipal commissioner and representatives of Amazon. “We are disappointed as they had no answers to basic question of what will be the source of the water required for cooling,” Ms. Pradhan said.

Concerns over water

A more pressing constraint for Visakhapatnam was inadequate storage capacity, a concern that engineers had flagged internally, D. Murali Krishna, Executive Engineer, Water Supply, of the Greater Visakhapat-

nam Municipal Corporation said. He said roughly 1,000 to 2,000 acres are needed to be set aside for reservoirs, and that around 5,000 million cubic feet of storage could sustain the city for nearly six months.

Meanwhile, the Thane project will require 422 MW power and backup of 193 generators. Wakeup Thanekar group said that Amazon and the Thane corporation have given two different figures on water usage. While Amazon claimed 125 kilolitres a day per day usage, the corporation announced that it will provide 12 million litres a day of recycled sewage water.

Jatin Kothare, a resident in Balkum, said that the city is already “short of 40 MLD water”.

“So how you going to fulfil the water requirements of the data centre?” he asked.

ADVERTISEMENT

SVAMITVA YOJANA TRANSFORMS MADHYA PRADESH WITH SECURE LAND RIGHTS AND FINANCIAL EMPOWERMENT

Free registration of property documents, easier bank loans and stronger legal ownership mark a new chapter in rural governance under Chief Minister Dr. Mohan Yadav, building on Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s vision of digitally mapped villages

‘SVAMITVA’ USHERS IN NEW ERA OF RURAL OWNERSHIP IN MADHYA PRADESH



Madhya Pradesh has emerged as one of the country’s foremost success stories in implementing the Centre’s ambitious ‘SVAMITVA’ (Survey of Villages and Mapping with Improved Technology in Village Areas) Scheme, converting millions of rural homes into legally recognised assets that unlock economic opportunity.

Driven by the vision of Prime Minister Narendra Modi, who launched the nationwide initiative to provide clear ownership rights to rural residents through drone-based surveys, the programme has received decisive momentum in the state under the leadership of Chief Minister Dr. Mohan Yadav. The state government has expanded the scope of the scheme beyond issuing property cards by ensuring that beneficiaries receive

registered ownership documents free of cost, removing one of the biggest hurdles faced by rural families in accessing formal banking services.

In a landmark decision, the Madhya Pradesh Cabinet approved the registration of property documents for all eligible ‘SVAMITVA’ beneficiaries at government expense. Nearly 48.32 lakh rural property holders will receive legally registered ownership documents without paying registration fees, cess or other statutory charges. The state government will spend over Rs. 3,800 crore to implement the initiative.

The decision addresses a long-standing challenge. Although lakhs of villagers had received ownership certificates under the ‘SVAMITVA’ Scheme, many banks were reluctant to accept those documents as adequate legal proof for sanctioning loans. With

formal registration, these documents will now carry stronger legal validity, enabling beneficiaries to mortgage their properties and obtain institutional credit for agriculture, small businesses, self-employment, education and other productive purposes.

Officials believe the move will fundamentally change the rural economy by transforming residential properties into bankable financial assets while simultaneously strengthening legal ownership, reducing disputes and simplifying inheritance and property transfers.

The state has also planned an extensive awareness campaign to ensure every eligible family understands the benefits of registration and the opportunities created by the scheme.

OPENING NEW DOORS FOR LOCAL DEVELOPMENT

Nearly complete across the State

Implementation of the ‘SVAMITVA’ Scheme has advanced rapidly across Madhya Pradesh.

Drone surveys have been carried out in more than 42,000 villages across all districts. Survey work has been completed in over 40,500 villages, resulting in nearly 66 lakh property records. More than 46 lakh property documents have already been distributed, while the remaining eligible beneficiaries are being covered in subsequent phases.

State officials estimate that implementation is almost 96 per cent complete, placing Madhya Pradesh among the country’s leading performers under the national programme.

Prime Minister’s direct engagement strengthens implementation

Prime Minister Narendra Modi has remained closely associated with the implementation of the ‘SVAMITVA’ Scheme, periodically interacting with beneficiaries through nationwide virtual programmes and electronically distributing property cards across the country.

In one such major initiative, more than 15.63 lakh beneficiaries in Madhya Pradesh received e-Property Cards during a nationwide distribution programme led by the Prime Minister.

These events have reinforced the objective of providing rural citizens with legally recognised ownership rights while integrating village properties into the formal financial system.

Chief Minister Dr. Mohan Yadav has participated in state-level programmes and consistently emphasised timely implementation, ensuring that benefits reach eligible households across Madhya Pradesh.

Revenue administration accelerates implementation

The Revenue Department has maintained close monitoring of the programme through regular review meetings and video conferences with district administrations.

Alongside reviewing revenue cases, the implementation of the farmer registry, and revenue collection, senior officials directed all districts to accord the highest priority to completing the ‘SVAMITVA’ Scheme.

Pending publication of ownership records has been expedited, with districts instructed to complete remaining

formalities within prescribed timelines so that beneficiaries receive their documents without delay.

State-level monitoring of pending revenue cases through the Revenue Case Management System has also been strengthened to improve administrative efficiency.

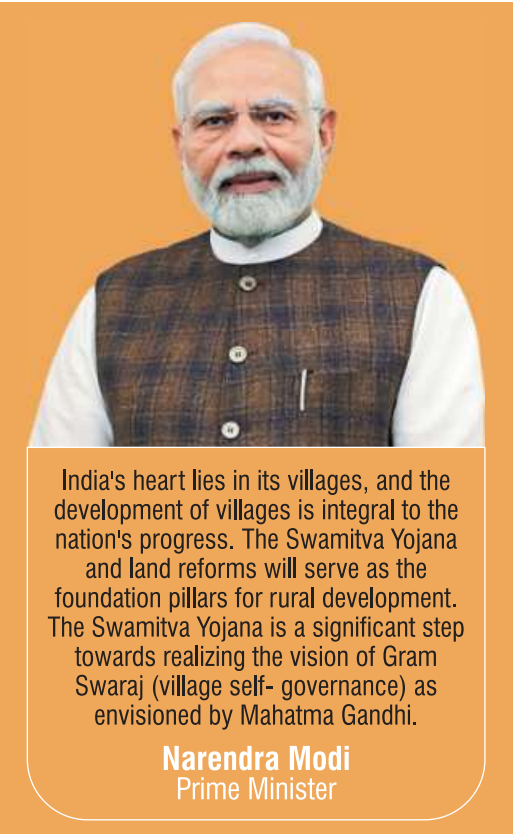
Technology brings transparenc

One of the defining features of the ‘SVAMITVA’ Scheme has been the extensive use of modern technology.

Drone surveys have mapped village habitation areas with remarkable precision, creating accurate digital property records for millions of rural residents.

Ground verification, public publication of records, objection hearings and final approvals have been completed under clearly defined procedures, making the process more transparent and reducing the scope for future disputes.

In several districts, administrative action was also initiated wherever discrepancies were detected during verification, reflecting the government’s



India’s heart lies in its villages, and the development of villages is integral to the nation’s progress. The Swamitva Yojana and land reforms will serve as the foundation pillars for rural development. The Swamitva Yojana is a significant step towards realizing the vision of Gram Swaraj (village self- governance) as envisioned by Mahatma Gandhi.

Narendra Modi
Prime Minister



emphasis on accountability and accuracy.

KEY HIGHLIGHTS

Free registration for rural families

The Madhya Pradesh Cabinet has approved free registration of property documents for nearly 48.32 lakh ‘SVAMITVA’ beneficiaries, with the state

bearing registration fees and related charges worth more than Rs. 3,800 crore.

Bank loans made easier

Legally registered ownership documents will allow rural households to use their properties as collateral for institutional credit, improving access to finance and encouraging entrepreneurship.

Statewide drone mapping

Drone surveys have covered over 42,000 villages, creating millions of digital property records and bringing transparency to rural land administration.

Strong monitoring

The Revenue Department is conducting continuous reviews to ensure timely publication of ownership records, speedy disposal of pending cases and completion of the scheme across all districts.

Special village-level campaigns

District administrations have organised verification drives, awareness programmes and distribution camps to ensure eligible beneficiaries receive their ownership documents efficiently.

Technology-driven governance

Digital mapping, online land records and systematic verification have strengthened legal certainty while reducing the likelihood of future land disputes.

Prime Minister’s vision, State’s execution

The ‘SVAMITVA’ Scheme reflects Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s vision of empowering rural India through secure property rights. Under the leadership of Chief Minister Dr. Yadav, Madhya Pradesh has translated that vision into one of the country’s most comprehensive land ownership programmes, laying the foundation for stronger rural livelihoods, financial inclusion and sustained economic growth.

DRIVING ECONOMIC GROWTH AND GOOD GOVERNANCE

Districts conduct special camps to speed up work

Across Madhya Pradesh, district administrations organised extensive field-level activities to ensure the scheme’s timely implementation.

Special camps were held in gram panchayats and tehsils for:

- Ground verification of surveyed properties
- Updating Records of Rights
- Publication of ownership records
- Disposal of claims and objections
- Farmer Registry work

Collectors reviewed preparations through regular meetings and directed officials to ensure smooth distribution of ownership documents while arranging live broadcasts of the Prime Minister’s address during national programmes.

The coordinated approach ensured that implementation reached villages through district, block and gram panchayat-level events.

Property ownership becomes an economic asset

For decades, thousands of rural families possessed houses and residential land without legally recognised ownership documents. The registration initiative changes that reality.

Registered ownership documents now provide rural households with:

- Easier access to bank loans
- Stronger legal ownership
- Better acceptance by financial institutions
- Simplified inheritance and transfer of property

- Reduced property disputes
- Greater opportunities for entrepreneurship and self-employment

The government expects easier access to institutional finance to encourage investment in agriculture, rural enterprises and small businesses while strengthening overall financial inclusion.

Madhya Pradesh among India’s best-performing states

The success of the ‘SVAMITVA’ Scheme forms part of a broader development narrative in Madhya Pradesh.

The state has consistently ranked among the country’s leading performers in implementing flagship programmes of the Government of India.

It has achieved full or near-complete implementation in several major schemes, including:

- PM-Kisan Samman Nidhi
- PM Jeevan Jyoti Bima Yojana
- SVAMITVA
- BharatNet
- Kisan Credit Card
- Atal Pension Yojana

The state has also exceeded national targets under schemes such as PM SVANIDHI, the Amrit Sarovar Mission and the Soil Health Card programme, while making substantial progress under the Jal Jeevan Mission, Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana, Ayushman Bharat and rural road connectivity programmes.



SCIENCE

A lost Himalayan people emerges from a Ladakh cave

Jacob Koshy

A study published recently in *Science Advances* has reported genome-wide data from 10 individuals recovered from a cave in Kargil. Radiocarbon dating places them at roughly 1,500 years before the present. One half were best proxied by present-day North Indians; the others were genetically closer to ancient Tibetans. Chromosome segments date that union to about 2,800 years ago, a

century before the Tibetan Empire. The bodies were carefully laid in their final resting place, Veena Mushrif-Tripathy of Deccan College, Pune, who co-led the excavation, said. “It indicates that this is a deliberate act of the people,” she told *The Hindu* in an email, describing a pre-Buddhist Ladakhi practice of laying the dead in natural caves. However, a second team reached the cave first. In a preprint posted in January,

Niraj Rai of the Birbal Sahni Institute of Palaeosciences, Lucknow, and Maanasa Raghavan of the University of Chicago reported genomes from five cave individuals and two from a second Ladakhi site. Each group said it didn’t know the other was working on the cave until the manuscripts appeared. David Reich, professor of genetics at Harvard Medical School and a corresponding author on the *Science Advances* paper,

said “this was not a race” and that “all the genetic research” happened independently. Both papers agreed on the genetic identities of the cave people as well as that their genes contained a third ‘ingredient’ – in the form of a population from Inner Asia. Since nobody has yet excavated the exact ancient Tibetan population that mixed into Ladakh, the Harvard-led team reached for a Bronze Age group from Xinjiang.

On the other hand, per the Lucknow-Chicago team, this third people were real people who crossed the passes, pointing to steppe motifs in Ladakh’s rock art. The papers also differ on when the peoples mixed: 2,800 years ago or 2,100-2,500 years ago. The preprint – Rai said it would appear in the next issue of *Science Advances* – called its result the oldest evidence yet of ancestral North Indian ancestry. This component underlies

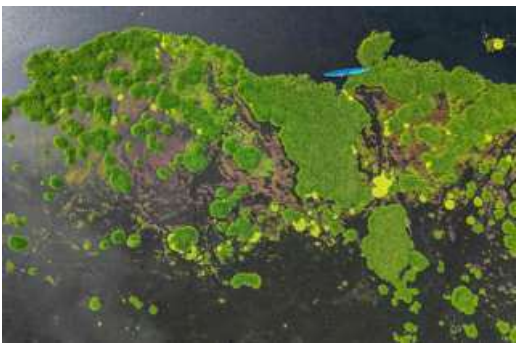
most North Indian and Pakistani populations today. The *Science Advances* paper said the same in different words. Dr. Reich said the evidence also indicated that the group of 10 people was local and that the mixing may not have happened in Ladakh at all. Dr. Mushrif-Tripathy said, however, that the community lived astride a trade route, where admixture could have been continuous.

SNAPSHOTS



First moon found beyond solar system is as big as a planet

Using the radial velocity method, astronomers have found a large body orbiting a brown dwarf, CD-35 2722 B, which orbits a star. It is estimated to be 90% as massive as Jupiter and orbiting the brown dwarf every 170 days on an oval path. The find is a milestone in the search for moons outside the solar system and challenges current ideas: the object is so large it blurs the line between a moon and a planet.



Invasive species affect the Global South more

The environmental consequences of invasive species have been found to be more severe in the Global South than in wealthier nations. Experts used to believe the Global North faced a greater threat as it reported more invasive species. But the study said these figures reflect wealthy countries conducting studies more often. Specifically, the authors found the actual damage per species is much higher in the Global South, driven by rapid trade growth plus poor environmental oversight.



AI helps take next stride on proteins in medicine

Researchers have developed a new tool called ContactSeek to enhance DNA base editing. Base editing is a powerful tool for gene therapy but often accidentally changes the wrong parts of a person’s DNA. The team used the AI model AlphaFold3 to predict the likelihood that specific parts of the editor protein will touch the DNA, finding this way to be more sensitive than extant 3D models. Thus they created improved versions of common editors, including Cas9.

India’s rice fields rank among world’s top methane sources

India is the world’s top rice producer, with its area under paddy cultivation covering 55% of its rainfed harvested area; continuous irrigation, incorporating residues and increasing use of nitrogen fertilizers has increased emissions

Sharmila Vaidyanathan

Greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions from paddy fields have doubled since the 1960s, a new study in *Nature Food* has found. In 2011-2020, paddy fields worldwide produced around 1.1 billion tonnes of carbon dioxide-equivalent (CO₂-e) emissions every year, up 90.4% from annual emissions in 1961-1980.

Per the study, around half the increase was driven by the loss of soil organic carbon. In 1961-1980, paddy fields removed 289 million tonnes of CO₂-e emissions annually. But by the 2010s, over a third of paddy fields worldwide had begun losing carbon.

Methane from paddy fields was also a significant driver. Flooded fields develop low-oxygen conditions where methane-producing microbes thrive. And paddy fields in eastern India were among the global methane hotspots.

“Most previous studies have focused on a single greenhouse gas, a specific management practice or a particular region,” Hanqin Tian, co-author of the study and director and institute professor, Department of Earth and Environmental Sciences, Boston College, the U.S., said. “Our study provides a much more comprehensive assessment by integrating a global meta-analysis of more than 1,200 field experiments, process-based ecosystem modelling, and artificial intelligence approaches to quantify GHG emissions from rice cultivation worldwide.”

Dirty rice

India’s irrigated paddy fields release more methane in a year than all of Germany



Rice is crucial for India’s food security. STEVE DOUGLAS/UNSPLASH

- Global greenhouse gas emissions from paddy fields have nearly doubled since the 1960s, a new study has found
- Half of the emissions increase stems from the loss of soil organic carbon in paddy fields worldwide
- High methane levels result from flooded fields, continuous irrigation, and heavy use of nitrogen fertilizers
- Better irrigation and residue management could reduce global rice emissions by 10% by the year 2050
- However, adopting new techniques is often constrained by labour shortages and a lack of technical knowledge among farmers
- Crop diversification and limiting paddy expansion are essential to meeting regional environmental and climate goals

India is the world’s top rice producer. Its area under paddy cultivation has increased by around 25% since the 1970s, currently covering 55% of India’s rainfed harvested area. This together with continuous irrigation, incorporating residues such as leftover stalks, leaves, and stubble, and increasing use of nitrogen fertilizers, has increased emissions.

“Our analysis indicates that a combination of improved irrigation, optimised fertilizer use, residue management, and reduced tillage could reduce global rice-related greenhouse gas emissions by about 10% by mid-century, even under a warming climate,” Dr. Tian said.

The study also projected that between 2031 and 2050, annual emissions will increase by a quarter, fuelled by global warming, erratic rainfall, and the intense use of agricultural inputs. Irrigated paddy fields

in India already release 3.9 million tonnes of methane a year, a little more than the annual methane emissions of Germany.

While India has not set up goals to reduce emissions from agriculture, some techniques and incentives are available to farmers. The National Innovations in Climate Resilient Agriculture (NICRA) project suggests – among others – the ‘System for Rice Intensification’ technique: young seedlings are transplanted and fields are not continuously flooded during irrigation, reducing emissions.

However, the methods don’t address the emission reduction potentials varying widely between States. Apart from demonstrations of alternatives across districts under NICRA, several national and State-level policies and incentives are designed to encourage farmers to adopt the alternative methods. However,

farmers remain reluctant, including due to labour shortages, lack of technical knowledge, and changes in rainfall patterns.

Prakashan Chellattan Veetil, senior agricultural and behavioural economist at the International Rice Research Institute (IRRI), New Delhi, said a regional approach that considers topography, soil, and irrigation conditions plus the farmers’ needs is crucial. Dr. Veetil is the IRRI lead in the KERA-AWD project to establish processes to cultivate low-emission rice systems in Kerala’s Thrissur kole lands and Palakkad Malampuzha canal regions.

“Using a multi-pronged approach, which includes increasing soil organic carbon, understanding the hydrology and aligned irrigation systems, agricultural inputs, residue management protocols, soil microbes and farmer preferences, we are working on

identifying low-emission packages, where a combination of these factors can help reduce emissions for various paddy varieties,” Dr. Veetil said.

He shared the example of lime that farmers use to neutralise the State’s acidic soil. “We have observed that replacing a portion of the lime with phosphogypsum has a positive impact on emissions in the subsoil surface. We are also experimenting with different formulations and application methods for nitrogen fertilizers.”

Ashwini Chhatre, associate professor of public policy and executive director at the Bharti Institute of Public Policy, Hyderabad, said that depending on a region’s suitability for paddy, farmers should have support to opt for low-emission techniques or grow alternative local crop varieties. In his research, Dr. Chhatre found that farmers still dedicate large areas of their farmlands to paddy. “As a general strategy, there is no way forward without crop diversification,” he said. “Despite the agro-climatic diversity in the country, paddy has the largest area under cultivation at the cost of regional indigenous crops.”

“An integrated intervention for alternative grains is crucial,” Dr. Chhatre continued, adding that it “must include” extension and training services, involve self-help groups, and provide procurement support. “Policies must also prevent further expansion of paddy fields to curb emissions.” (Sharmila Vaidyanathan is an independent journalist from Bengaluru)

Zoopharmacognosy — when animals medicate themselves



SPEAKING OF SCIENCE

D. Balasubramanian

An interesting review by G. Allen et al. in *Scientific Reports* (16,18690: 2026) reports on how orangutans, which are still present in the Sebangau forest in Central Kalimantan region in Indonesia, treat themselves by mixing saliva with the leaves of a plant botanists that call dracaena (a member of the asparagus family) and applying the mixture to their body in order to purify the air and relieve muscle pain and joint discomfort while carrying their babies.

Botanists from Gujarat University, Ahmedabad, had previously shown that this evergreen plant has

antioxidant, antibacterial, antifungal, and anticancer activities (Vasava et al., *Int. J. R. Tech.*, 2025; 117-120). Chimpanzees in Nigeria have also been known to swallow leaves of the plant *Desmodium gangeticum* (called ‘shalaparni’ in India) to get rid of parasites that bother the animal’s skin. Ancient Ayurveda practitioners such as Sushruta were also known to use this plant and its parts as parts of formulations to manage asthma, haemorrhoids, and typhoid. What our ancestral primates millennia ago had practised has come down to us humans, and today we use several available plants such as snake plant, ginseng, oregano, and others for medicinal purposes.

Based on the fact that animals use plants like these to treat themselves, plant biologists have



A male Sumatran orangutan seen after self-treating a wound with a medicinal plant in the Suaq Balimbing research site in 2022. REUTERS

coined the term ‘zoopharmacognosy’ – ‘zoo’ stands for animals, ‘pharmaco’ for medicines, and ‘gnosy’ for knowledge. In the March 2008 issue of *Resonance*, the journal of the Indian Academy of Sciences, R. Raman and S. Kandula had reviewed this aspect of animals (vol. 13, pages 245-253 (2008)). Wikipedia itself lists around 70 publications in this

area: of animals self-medicating with plants, roots, and fruits.

Even common elephants have been known to chew the leaves of the oregano plant for relief from phlegm. Monkeys, sheep, dogs, and cats are also known to self-medicate by eating grass to remove parasites such as worms and amoeba that cause illness in the body.

They also consume clay or soil particles, counting on substances therein to alleviate pain. This practice is referred to as geophagy – ‘geo’ referring to earth and ‘phagy’ to consuming. Birds are also known to use herbs to protect their nests from invaders (*Phil. Trans. R. Soc. B* (2018) 373 (1751): 20170196).

What about plants? Unlike animals, plants do not have a nervous system, although they too can sense their environment, respond to insect attacks, and try to defend themselves against herbivores.

There is also evidence that monkeys share with humans the ability to track auditory regularities. In other words they also possess a faculty to appreciate music. Y. Ayala et al., in 2017 (*Scientific Reports* 7, 16687), pointed out that the rhesus monkeys res-

pond to the acoustic syllables (musical scales), though not the rhythmic patterns as we humans do. Also in 2017, scientists at Glasgow University showed (DOI: 10.1016/j.physbeh.2017.01.024) that dogs show measurable changes in behaviour, heart rate, and stress levels when exposed to music, though the responses varied by genre, tempo, and the individual dog. On the other hand, cats have been found to respond to far different audio frequencies.

We should keep these details in mind when exposing animals to stressful environments like shelters and veterinary clinics, where the right kind of music can visibly calm anxious animals. As for friends with pet dogs: play music and let your dog enjoy it too! dbala@lvpei.org



Question Corner

Follow the chemistry

How did we identify fossil fuels to be remains of fossils, particularly those of dinosaurs? – Vivek Keshri, Patna

Scientists identified fossil fuels to be the remains of ancient life using physical and chemical evidence. Early on, some scientists thought oil was a mineral ‘sweated’ out of the earth’s interior. But in the 16th century, naturalists found imprints of leaves and tree trunks inside coal seams, suggesting that coal is compressed plant matter. Modern chemists also found molecules in crude oil that are only produced by living organisms, such as hopanoids and steranes. Finally, plants prefer to use

the lighter isotope of carbon (carbon-12) during photosynthesis – and fossil fuels are highly enriched in carbon-12 relative to carbon of inorganic origins. Fossil fuels are never from dinosaurs. In 1930, the Sinclair Oil Corporation used a dinosaur in a marketing campaign to emphasise the ancient and natural qualities of its oil. They also sponsored a dinosaur exhibit at the 1933 Chicago World’s Fair. Further, the word ‘fossil’ originally meant anything dug up from the ground, and was used in the 1700s to refer to coal or oil deposits.

Readers may send their questions / answers to science@thehindu.co.in

PROFILES

Masters of the midfield

Spanish football team

With aggressive defence and precise attack, La Roja’s young champions blended the country’s timeless philosophy of control with a more direct, adaptable style to win a second football World Cup

Anirudh Velamuri

In 2010, Spain reached the pinnacle of international football with a squad overflowing with established stars. A generation of world-class players combined technical brilliance, tactical intelligence and an unwavering belief in the power of possession to secure the nation’s first FIFA World Cup title. The team that won its maiden World Cup title also lifted the European Championship before and after it. That squad set a benchmark for Spanish, nay, world football. For years, every side was forced to live in the shadows of that generation.

Comparisons became inevitable and only intensified after Spain’s group-stage exit in 2014 and a pair of Round of 16 exits at the 2018 and 2022 World Cups. Every edition ended with the same question: Was Spain trying too hard to recreate the past? In 2026, the answer finally arrived in the form of another World Cup-winning side that respected its history without becoming trapped by it. This group, like that all-conquering generation, still valued technique above chaos and considered the ball an ally rather than something to be surrendered.

But they were also more open to embracing life beyond tiki-taka. They defended with greater aggression, attacked more directly when required and, above all, seamlessly married beautiful football with “ugly” decisions. They showed immense maturity for a squad that was one of the youngest in the entire tournament.

Every nation prepared for one version of Spain and encountered a completely different one. Those expecting endless sideways passes were instead faced with quick vertical attacks. Those anticipating a fragile defence discovered a back line that relished physical battles. They made every new environment their own, turned every challenge into familiar ground. And they did so without losing their identity.

When La Roja opened its campaign with a frustrating goalless draw against tournament debutant Cape Verde, it



AP

gave critics ammunition to question its credentials. But Luis de la Fuente’s side, among the firm favourites early on, carried on unfazed.

If Austria was dismantled with authority, Portugal was bested through discipline. If Belgium was outmanoeuvred, France was comprehensively outplayed. If Argentina entered the final buoyed by Lionel Messi’s last dance, La Albiceleste found itself stripped of both sentiment and solutions, suffocated by a side that made sure the music stopped on its terms.

The famous 2010 side, led by Xavi Hernandez, Andres Iniesta, Xabi Alonso and Sergio Busquets, perfected possession football. They suffocated opponents with the ball and patiently waited to exploit the smallest defensive mistakes. While that side’s victories were often narrow, they rarely felt fortunate. This year’s champions inherited many of those principles but expressed them differently. If the 2010 side resembled an orchestra where every movement was carefully choreographed, this team felt more like a modern jazz ensemble. The

structure remained, but there was greater freedom within it.

Grace under pressure

Every great football nation has always had a personality. Brazil is celebrated for improvisation and individual creativity, Italy built its reputation on defensive intelligence, and Germany has often represented organisation, efficiency and physical strength.

At its heart, Spanish football has always been built on one simple conviction: the ball is the team’s greatest defender. At the grassroots level all around the country, children are taught that possession is not merely a statistic but a form of control. Keep the ball to dictate the rhythm, choose where and how the game is played, and, consequently, prevent the opposition from attacking. It is football choreographed by geometry, brought to life by instinct.

The results are as clear as day. The country has a conveyor belt of footballers who appear comfortable in situations that would unsettle most.

Those who come out of the Spanish system stand out immediately, and

their technical superiority puts them in high demand.

Its style is often unfairly reduced to one word: possession. But possession was never the true objective; control was. While most players would look at ways to run past opponents, those from the Spanish schools look for ways to make the opponent move first. They might not always dominate through physical presence, but they excel because they understand where the game is going before others do.

It is not just world-class players that Spain produces time and again, but also talented head coaches that have established themselves as the game’s best – like Pep Guardiola, Luis Enrique, the late Tito Vilanova, Unai Emery, Xabi Alonso and Andoni Iraola, to name a few.

De la Fuente has now taken his place among Spain’s best. Incidentally, his entry into the national system began with him answering a job advertisement posted by the Royal Spanish Football Federation (RFEF) for youth team coaches, 18 months after being sacked by Deportivo Alaves in 2011. Initially handed a temporary

contract, the 65-year-old steadily rose through the youth ranks, winning the Under-19 and Under-21 Euros, before eventually taking charge of the senior national team. Today, he is the oldest manager to win the World Cup.

Evolution without dilution

The 2026 World Cup-winning team took that Spanish identity and imposed it with ruthless precision. Across 39 days, Spain proved that brain could still triumph over brawn at the very top of international football.

Every great Spanish team has its roots set in midfield. This campaign was no different. Led by captain and Ballon d’Or holder Rodri, it controlled and dictated the speed of the match – slow when Spain needed patience and fast when opponents showed vulnerability. They controlled the match and refused to become frustrated even as the goal remained elusive. Argentina’s defence resisted wave after wave for 105 minutes. A dozen Spaniards had a crack at goal, and somehow Emi Martinez stood tall. Time was slipping away, yet Spain stayed patient and refused to take its foot off the gas until it got to a point where a breakthrough felt inevitable.

It eventually came from Ferran Torres, a player that few would have picked as a game-winner. Doubts on his abilities only grew stronger when he hit the bar rather than the back of the net against Cape Verde and Uruguay earlier in the tournament. But on the biggest stage, fate finally smiled on him, as Torres provided the release with Spain’s 20th shot of the night. In a tournament that featured the brilliance of Messi, Kylian Mbappe and Erling Haaland, Spain offered a different kind of reminder: that football’s greatest force is often not an individual, but an idea shared by eleven players.

If the first star on Spain’s shirt represents a generation that conquered the world by perfecting control, the second belongs to one that proved control could be reinvented. Perhaps Spain’s biggest triumph, as the confetti settles, is proving that its golden generation is not merely a chapter in the past.

THE GIST

When La Roja opened its campaign with a frustrating goalless draw against tournament debutant Cape Verde, it gave critics ammunition to question its credentials

But Austria was dismantled with authority, Portugal was bested through discipline, Belgium was outmanoeuvred, France was comprehensively outplayed

In a tournament that featured the brilliance of Messi, Mbappe and Haaland, Spain offered a different reminder: that football’s greatest force is often not an individual, but an idea shared by eleven players

In the eye of the storm

Dharmendra Pradhan

The Union Education Minister has tendered his resignation as protests over exam paper leak persisted, mounting pressure on the Narendra Modi government

Nistula Hebbar

Dharmendra Pradhan’s resignation as Union Education Minister marks an unusual interlude in a political career that had enjoyed a steady rise. A controversy of such magnitude engulfed him that it became a contest between his staying in office and addressing the anxieties of an entire generation, with GenZ protests ultimately emerging victorious.

Nothing in Mr. Pradhan’s career had foreshadowed such a denouement. Born in Talcher, Odisha, in 1969, he comes from a family long associated with the Rashtriya Swayamsewak Sangh (RSS), the ideological parent organisation of the BJP. His father, Debendra Pradhan, was an RSS functionary, who joined the BJP in 1980. He was elected to the Lok Sabha from Deogarh and served as Union Minister for Surface Transport in the Vajpayee government from 1998 to 2001.

Mr. Pradhan started his political journey with the Akhil Bharatiya Vidyarthi Parishad (ABVP), the student wing of the RSS, and later became a member of the Bharatiya Janata Yuva Morcha (BJYM), the youth wing of the BJP. He earned a degree in Anthropology from Utkal University in Bhubaneswar.

In an ironic twist, foot-



ILLUSTRATION: SREEJITH R. KUMAR

age of an ABVP protest march Mr. Pradhan led to the Odisha Assembly in 1997 against an alleged exam paper leak – and in which he was beaten by the police – has resurfaced amid the anti-NEET protests. The three-decade gap between the two events encapsulates not only Mr. Pradhan’s political journey but also the enduring problem of exam leaks and youth unrest.

He won his first Assembly election in 2000 from Pallahara, Odisha. His first Lok Sabha victory was in 2004 from Deogarh (when he also became national president of the BJYM). He then became the national secretary and national general secretary of the BJP and got elected to the Lok Sabha again in 2024. He has also served two terms as a member of the Rajya Sabha.

When Prime Minister Narendra Modi assumed office in 2014, Mr. Pradhan was made Minister for Petroleum and Natural Gas, a position he would hold for seven years, becoming the

country’s longest-serving Petroleum Minister. He was the Minister when the Ujjwala Yojana of free cooking gas connections for the poor was launched. In 2021, he became the Education Minister, a portfolio that was ideologically most important to the Sangh Parivar.

Start of troubles

It is easy to assume that Mr. Pradhan’s troubles began with the leak of the NEET exam paper in 2024, just as the third Modi government took office. The repeat leak in 2026 may appear to have been the final straw. In reality, however, much like Mr. Pradhan’s own steady rise in the BJP, his political woes accumulated gradually, gathering momentum with each passing controversy.

It started with the National Council of Educational Research and Training (NCERT), whose teacher training manual described sex as “biological” and gender as “a social construct” – Sangh Parivar sympathisers denounced

this formulation as pushing a “woke agenda”. This was followed by the University Grants Commission’s (UGC) ‘equity regulations’, which defined caste-based discrimination as discrimination “only on the basis of caste or tribe” against members of the Scheduled Castes (SCs), Scheduled Tribes (STs), and Other Backward Classes (OBCs), while prescribing no penalties for false complaints against those from the General Category. Then came the NEET paper leak, complaints by students about the CBSE marking process, alleged security vulnerabilities and answer-sheet mix-ups.

The middle class saw its belief in professional qualifications as a pathway to social mobility being undermined under the watch of a government it had backed for more than a decade. The right wing felt Mr. Pradhan, distracted by state politics, had been asleep at the wheel – negligent when he should have been vigilant. With the youth enraged, the right wing apathetic, and the newly minted Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) deploying a new grammar of protest, a storm was beginning to form.

The steady ascent of Mr. Pradhan’s political career was halted by a generation-defining protest. For someone who hadn’t stumbled once on his way to the top, it was an unexpected slip.

Iran’s natural fortress

Pickaxe Mountain

The mountain range that U.S. President Donald Trump has threatened to strike is composed of volcanic rocks that could complicate efforts to penetrate deeply buried facilities

Vasudevan Mukunth

“We’ll be hitting that area very probably pretty soon, and there’s not a thing they can do about it,” U.S. President Donald Trump recently said about Pickaxe Mountain, a geological formation around 220 km south of Tehran.

The locals call it Kuh-e Kolang Gaz La. Recent satellite images showed a flurry of activity around the formation, including the movement of vehicles, and entrances to what appear to be tunnels. What is under the mountain is not clear, although Israeli intelligence seems to believe it houses a part of Iran’s nuclear programme.

Pickaxe Mountain is part of the Karkas Range, or Reshteh Kuh-e Karkas. It extends for more than 100 km in a northwest-southeast ‘diagonal’ between the cities of Kashan and Ardestan and is named for its highest summit, Mount Karkas, which rises to about 3.9 km above sea level in the midst of an arid plateau. The Range is part of the Urumieh-Dokhtar magmatic belt, and its mountains hold evidence of millions of years of volcanic activity and tectonic deformation. Specifically, the Urumieh-Dokhtar belt developed as the Neo-Tethyan Ocean subducted beneath the Iranian continental margin before



REUTERS

Arabia finally collided with Eurasia, in the last 66 million years.

The tectonic activity generated large quantities of calc-alkaline magma and thick lava flows and the attendant accumulations of volcanic breccia and ash deposits. Thus, much of the bedrock exposed in the Karkas Range consists of volcanic rocks such as andesite and rhyolite together with pyroclastic deposits and younger sedimentary units.

A 2019 study led by Panthea Giahchi of the Geological Survey and Mineral Exploration of Iran (GSMEI) reported that the landforms of the Karkas massif were shaped by rock type and climate together. The range sports steep ridges, landslide deposits, rock-falls, and extensive alluvial sediments. Andesite rocks generally form dense and mechanically strong masses and rhyolite rocks often (though not always) host many fractures.

According to some regional GSMEI maps, the Range is also dissected by

numerous faults, creating a structurally complex formation. This is why understanding how specific parts of the Range will respond to missile strikes and explosions is complicated.

Volcanic landscape

Within this craggy volcanic landscape sits Pickaxe Mountain, in the form of a ridge just south of Natanz. Despite its prominence, there appear to be no peer-reviewed geological studies of the mountain: most assessments in the public domain are based on geological maps and satellite data, and details extrapolated from what is known about the Karkas Range itself. GSMEI maps indicate that Pickaxe Mountain also consists of volcanic rocks such as andesite, rhyolite, dacite, and their associated pyroclastic units – and with variations in the lithology, density of fractures, faulting patterns, weathering, and groundwater intrusion together affecting its mechanical characteristics. Andesites, rhyolites, and volcanic tuffs transmit

seismic and shock waves differently from one another. The fault zones also create planes of weakness that in turn influence the stress response of the adjacent rock mass.

Geological uncertainty is often pronounced in projects involving volcanic rocks. To excavate Pickaxe Mountain itself, local experts might have characterised the rock units, charted their fractures and faults, tested their mechanical properties in the lab, and only then planned the excavation.

But as much as volcanic rocks complicate an excavation, they could complicate a bombing as well. In-tact andesite, dacite, rhyolite, and basalt often require more energy than many sedimentary rocks to fracture. And while natural fractures sound like flaws, they can scatter stress waves by splitting the energy up among many discontinuous formations.

In fact, Pickaxe Mountain may be a symbol of Iran’s geo-strategic riches. Its volcanic geology could make deep penetration more difficult. Any ground campaign would have to navigate a rugged landscape. And the surrounding maritime network has three major chokepoints – the Straits of Hormuz and Bab el-Mandeb and the Suez Canal – giving Iran and its allies outsized opportunities to disrupt maritime traffic.

BEIJING

China evacuates people, suspends rail services as Typhoon Noul nears



Authorities have evacuated more than 3,40,000 people and suspended rail services as Typhoon Noul approaches southern China, with flight cancellations announced in the financial hub of Hong Kong. The typhoon is forecast to make landfall in the coastal area between Saturday evening and Sunday morning. AFP

UNITED NATIONS

Turk's term as UN rights chief extended despite U.S. warnings



The United Nations General Assembly voted on Friday to renew Volker Turk's mandate as high commissioner for human rights for four years despite strong opposition from the United States, Russia and Israel. Mr. Turk has served as high commissioner since October 2022, and has emphasised the universality of human rights. AFP

CARACAS

Venezuela notifies United Nations of pull-out from ICC, alleging 'bias'



Venezuela's Foreign Minister Felix Plasencia said on Friday the country has formally notified the United Nations of its "irrevocable" decision to withdraw from the International Criminal Court. The government justified the move by alleging a "geographical bias" within court, claiming it targets nations in the Global South. REUTERS

BUCHAREST

Romania shoots down a second drone in 2 days: Defence Minister



Romania shot down a drone in its airspace on Saturday for the second day in a row, marking the second time since the start of Russia's full-scale invasion of Ukraine, it said. It was shot down 9.6 km west of Sfantu Gheorghe in the Danube Delta near the border with Ukraine, Defence Minister Radu Miruta said. AFP

Houthis fire missiles and drones at Saudi Arabia in response to strikes

Houthis said they targeted facilities in the Red Sea Saudi cities of Yanbu and Jizan that belong to Aramco, the world's largest oil company; there were no strikes overnight in Iran, in an apparent break from nearly two weeks of consecutive U.S. attacks

Associated Press
CAIRO

Yemen's Iran-backed Houthi rebels said on Saturday they fired missiles and drones at Saudi Arabia in response to Saudi airstrikes on the strategic Red Sea city of Hodeida, in another escalation over vital shipping routes in West Asia while the U.S. and Iran vie for control of the Strait of Hormuz.

Brig. Gen. Yahya Saree, the Houthis' military spokesman, said in a pre-recorded statement that the attack targeted facilities in the Red Sea cities of Yanbu and Jizan that belong to Aramco, the world's largest



Escalating tensions: Clouds of smoke rise after strikes on the Saudi Aramco refinery in Jizan on Saturday. AFP

oil company. Saudi Arabia's civil defence said alerts sounded multiple times early Saturday in both cities, but the Kingdom hasn't commented

further. There were no reported strikes overnight in Iran, in an apparent break from nearly two weeks of consecutive nights of U.S. attacks, though tension re-

mains high following a recent escalation between the two countries over the Strait of Hormuz.

The rising tension in the Red Sea threatens to further choke global shipping because the rebels have said they would close the Bab el-Mandeb Strait to Saudi-linked shipping.

The Houthis targeted two Saudi oil tankers in the Red Sea this week. In response, Saudi Arabia struck the Yemeni port city of Hodeida, the Saudi-led coalition in Yemen said early Saturday.

The Saudi-led coalition fighting in Yemen said it didn't hit the port but struck "legitimate military

targets" in Hodeida province, which "were linked to threats to commercial vessels in the Red Sea".

Iran's Foreign Minister, Abbas Araghchi, called for "diplomacy and dialogue" to solve the Yemen conflict without "military confrontations" in an interview published Saturday in the state-run Iran newspaper.

"Iran had a peaceful night," Hossein Kermanpour, a spokesperson for Iran's Health Ministry, posted Saturday on X.

U.S. Central Command didn't immediately respond to a request for comment. However, unlike the previous 13 nights, it didn't announce new strikes.

Wildfires in Spain, France force over 2,60,000 to flee

Agence France-Presse
EL ESCORIAL

Out-of-control wildfires in Spain and France that have forced the evacuation of more than 2,60,000 people raged on Saturday near Madrid and Bordeaux, with Paris mobilising its military to help overstretched firefighters.

France hustled 1,97,000 people from areas around Bordeaux – including vacation spots crowded this time of year – in what was "probably" the biggest peacetime evacuation the country has seen, its Interior Minister said.

In Spain, where 60,000 people were evacuated from villages west of Madrid, Prime Minister Pedro Sanchez said the priority was "to save lives" as he visited the fire zone.



Firefighters battle a fire surrounding La Atalaya residential area in El Tiemblo, 80 km west of Madrid, Spain, on Saturday. AFP

In the Spanish town of Brunete, west of Madrid, mayor Mar Nicolas said she was "very worried". "Every year there are fires, but this one has been tremendous," she said.

A separate wildfire near the eastern Spanish city of Valencia killed one person before firefighters brought it under control.

Overstretched firefighters in Spain and France battling around the clock for days have been unable to contain the infernos, though authorities in both countries suggested the intensity of some of the blazes had notched down.

Two French firefighters died earlier this week near Bordeaux.

Israeli troops round up Palestinians in West Bank village

Associated Press
NABLUS

Israel's military said it detained over 70 suspects across the occupied West Bank overnight and on Saturday, a day after troops deployed across the territory following violence that left two Israeli soldiers and four Palestinians dead.

Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu vowed to take "powerful action", including demolishing the home of the family of one of the Palestinians involved. Mr. Netanyahu's office said he would accelerate the approval of construction of more Israeli settlements in the area. The Israeli military later



Benjamin Netanyahu

on Saturday said a violent confrontation broke out between Israelis and Palestinians in the hilltop settlement of Susya in the southern West Bank, where Israelis and Palestinians threw rocks at each other. Palestinian officials did not immediately comment on the incident.

Russian, Ukrainian officials report 14 dead in latest attacks

Associated Press
MOSCOW

Ukrainian attacks on holiday camps in the partly Russian-occupied Zaporizhzhia region have killed 11 people, Moscow-installed officials said on Saturday, while authorities in Ukraine's northeastern Sumy region said a Russian drone strike killed three persons.

The strikes followed a major Russian attack on Friday near Kyiv that killed at least 10 people and wounded around 100 others, part of a relentless cycle of tit-for-tat attacks that dims the potential of reaching a diplomatic end to Russia's more than 4-

year-old invasion of its neighbour.

Four children were among 11 people killed in the attack on the resorts in Zaporizhzhia, Yevgeny Balitsky, the Kremlin-installed regional head, said, adding that 16 others were wounded.

Sumy regional head Oleh Hryhorov said on Saturday three persons were killed when a large fire broke out after a Russian drone struck a "civilian facility," adding that the victims were drivers for private Ukrainian postal and courier service Nova Poshta. Russia's Defence Ministry said it attacked a "storage and launch site" for Ukrainian drones.

Bill in U.S. Senate seeks three-year pause on H-1B visas, codify \$100K fee

Press Trust of India
WASHINGTON

A U.S. senator has introduced a Bill in the Senate that seeks to pause issuance of new H-1B visas for three years and codify the \$100,000 fee imposed by the Trump administration, which was struck down by a federal court.

U.S. Senator Tim Sheehy, a Republican from Montana, said the U.S. should not be issuing visas that make it easier to undercut the rights of American workers.

The H-1B visa is a non-immigrant visa that allows U.S. companies to employ highly skilled foreign workers in specialty occupations that require theoreti-



Donald Trump had issued a proclamation in September last year imposing a \$100,000 fee for obtaining new H-1B visas. REUTERS

cal or technical expertise. American technology companies depend on it to hire tens of thousands of employees each year from countries like India and China.

"The H-1B programme was created to address

workforce shortages for specialised, difficult-to-fill positions – not to displace qualified, hardworking Americans with cheaper, foreign labour," Mr. Sheehy said in a statement on Thursday.

"My legislation, the End

H-1B Abuse Act, restores the programme to its original intent and puts American workers first by closing loopholes that incentivise abuse, strengthening guardrails and prioritising our national security interests," he said.

The three-judge Bench at the Boston-based First Circuit Court of Appeals on Friday denied the federal government's motion to stay U.S. District Judge Leo T. Sorokin's June 8 ruling that struck down the fee, terming it an unlawful tax not authorised by Congress.

Mr. Trump had issued a proclamation in September last year imposing a \$100,000 fee for obtaining new H-1B visas.

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HARD-FOUGHT WIN

Sachin survives stern Canadian test to make pre-quarterfinals



India's Sachin Siwach survived a stern challenge from familiar foe Keoma Al-Ahmadih of Canada to enter the men's 60kg pre-quarterfinals of the Commonwealth Games boxing competition in Glasgow on Saturday. Sachin secured a 4-1 split decision victory in the first-round bout at the SEC Centre.

MIXED FORTUNES

Rupa and Pinki pair extends winning run; Sonowal loses



India's Rupa Rani Turkey and Pinki Singh recorded a third straight win and moved closer to the semifinal in women's pairs Section B of the lawn bowls competition at the Commonwealth Games in Glasgow. In men's singles, Putul Sonowal tasted his first defeat in Section D after notching up back-to-back victories.

MASTERSTROKE

We felt that the slower deliveries would be effective: Yash Thakur



Debutant India bowler Yash Thakur, who returned figures of 4-0-30-2, said taking the pace off the deliveries proved a masterstroke. "Shreyas [Iyer] *bhai* and I discussed our plans before the innings. We felt that the slower ball would be a very effective option on this pitch, and it worked for us," Yash Thakur said.

LATEST UPDATE

Anahat is first Indian to emerge World junior squash champion



Anahat Singh became the first Indian to be crowned World junior squash champion after she defeated Ruqayya Salem of Egypt in the summit clash at Ontario on Saturday. World No. 20 and top seed Anahat cruised past Salem 11-3, 11-7, 11-9. Anahat won a bronze last year after reaching the semifinals.

A tale of guts and glory as Jhandu opens tally

The para powerlifter from Bihar clinches bronze in the heavyweight category; head coach J.P. Singh appeals to the Central and State governments to provide a job for the medallist

C'WEALTH GAMES

K. Keerthivasan
GLASGOW

It is not easy being Jhandu Kumar. For someone who has battled poverty for most of his life, winning the bronze medal in the men's heavyweight para powerlifting event of the Commonwealth Games at the Scottish Event Campus here on Friday was nothing short of extraordinary. When Jhandu won India's first medal of the Games amassing 130.9 points after successfully lifting 181kg and 190kg, it was around 9.15 p.m. local time, when most people back home were asleep.

But the handful of Indian supporters and officials at the venue applauded an athlete whose journey to the podium has been paved with hardship and sacrifice.

Nigeria's Idris Riluan scored 132.8 points to win the gold while England's Matthew Harding (131) bagged the silver.

"I would like to thank my coaches and parents," Jhandu said.

Staying calm

As each lifter let out a roar before attempting every bench press, Jhandu remained characteristically composed.

There was little outward emotion from the Indian, perhaps he had long internalised the pain and struggles that life had thrown at him.

Born in Harnaut in Bi-



Tough cookie: Jhandu has defied the odds to make it to the podium. GETTY IMAGES

har's Nalanda district, Jhandu comes from a humble family. The son of a vegetable vendor, he spent most of his childhood helping his parents. To supplement the family's income, he also took up odd jobs and even drove an e-rickshaw after the family's financial situation worsened.

When asked Jhandu about those tough years, he paused for a moment. He couldn't say much as he possibly reflected on the difficulties endured by both him and his family.

Before he could respond, J.P. Singh, head coach of the Indian men's and women's para powerlifting team, stepped in with an emotional appeal.

"I request both the Cen-

tral and State Governments to reward Jhandu appropriately and provide him with a job. He truly deserves it after everything he has gone through," Singh told *The Hindu*.

Jhandu's life changed when Paralympic medallist Rajinder Singh Rahelu spotted his talent and brought him to the Sports Authority of India's National Centre of Excellence in Gandhinagar, where he has trained ever since. Watching his protege deliver India's first medal of the Games was an emotional moment for the veteran coach.

A National champion while representing Bihar in 72kg in 2024-25 with a best lift of 205kg, Jhandu established himself as one of

India's brightest prospects in the sport by winning a bronze medal at the 2025 para powerlifting World Cup in Beijing.

"He can do even better and win gold medals at the World Championships," Rajinder said here on Friday. "He has excellent technique and, more importantly, he is mentally very strong."

Rajinder echoed those sentiments, praising Jhandu's calm demeanor and quiet determination.

As Jhandu was wheeled away after patiently obliging every interview request, he quietly acknowledged the congratulations from the volunteers, officials and passers-by with a gentle smile before exiting the venue.

Fine chance for India's promising weightlifters

K. Keerthivasan
GLASGOW

The five-day weightlifting competition of the Commonwealth Games beginning at the Scottish Event Campus here on Sunday is packed with world-class talent.

The biggest star is Canada's Maude Charron in the women's 63kg category. A two-time Olympic medalist and World Championships medallist, Charron is one of the most accomplished athletes in the field.

Like India's Mirabai Chanu, the 33-year-old is chasing a third consecutive gold medal at the Games. Only three men – Precious McKenzie, Louis Martin and David Morgan – have performed the feat. No woman has achieved the distinction since women's weightlifting was introduced in the 2002 edition.

Another marquee name is England's Emily Campbell in the women's +87kg division. Campbell is a two-time Olympic medalist, having won silver at Tokyo 2020 and bronze at Paris 2024 (+81 kg).

Bindyarani Devi (58kg), Nirupama Devi Seram (63kg), Gyaneshwari Devi (53kg), Ajay Babu (79kg) and Raja Muthupandi (65kg) represent the next generation of Indian lifters.

India's chief coach Vijay Sharma has picked Gyaneshwari, Ajay and Raja as young lifters capable of winning medals.

It is an ideal opportunity for the next generation of lifters to step out of Mirabai's shadows, prove themselves on the international stage and ensure the country's rich legacy continues.

Kishan, Tilak and bowlers seal India's series victory



On the charge: Kishan and Tilak took the attack to the Zimbabwe bowlers. AFP & AP

INDIA IN ZIMBABWE

Press Trust of India
HARARE

Power-packed half-centuries from southpaws Ishan Kishan and Tilak Varma followed by a fine display from the bowlers helped India trump Zimbabwe by 90 runs in the second T20I here on Saturday. With the victory, the visitor took an unassailable 2-0 lead in the three-match series.

Chasing 220 was never going to be easy for the African side and the fate of the match was sealed when it lost five wickets inside nine overs. Eventually, the home team was bundled out for 129 in reply to India's 219 for five, which was constructed around Kishan's 81 (44b, 9x4, 2x6) and Tilak's unbeaten 60 (29b, 5x4, 3x6).

Kishan brought up his half-century off 31 balls, but the next 31 runs came off just 13 deliveries as he pressed on the accelerator. Tilak, for now, doused the

SCOREBOARD

INDIA
Vaibhav Sooryavanshi c Muzarabani b Ngarava 20 (9b, 3x4, 1x6), Abhishek Sharma c Burl b Muzarabani 8 (8b, 2x4), Ishan Kishan c Bennett b Nyamhuri 81 (44b, 9x4, 2x6), Shreyas Iyer c Evans b Bennett 25 (20b, 4x4), Tilak Varma (not out) 60 (29b, 5x4, 3x6), Rinku Singh c Burl b Evans 12 (8b, 1x6), Shivam Dube (not out) 6 (3b, 1x4); Extras (lb-2, nb-1, w-4): 7; Total (for five wkts. in 20 overs): 219.
FALL OF WICKETS
1-10 (Abhishek, 1.5 overs), 2-29 (Sooryavanshi, 2.6), 3-95 (Shreyas, 9.6), 4-189 (Kishan, 17.1), 5-213 (Rinku, 19.3).
ZIMBABWE BOWLING
Sikandar 4-0-47-0, Muzarabani 4-0-36-1, Ngarava 3-0-43-1, Evans 4-0-44-1, Nyamhuri 3-0-25-1, Bennett 2-0-22-1.
ZIMBABWE
Brian Bennett c Kishan b Yash Thakur 32 (19b, 3x4, 3x6), Ben Curran c Dube b Prince 1 (5b), Dion Myers b Bishnoi 12 (9b, 2x4), Ryan Burl c Rinku b Tilak 20 (18b,

2x4), Sikandar Raza c Kishan b Prince 0 (3b), Westly Madhevere c Shreyas b Dube 2 (3b), Tadiwanashe Marumani b Yash Thakur 24 (19b, 1x4, 1x6), Brad Evans b Abhishek 19 (11b, 1x4, 2x6), Newman Nyamhuri b Abhishek 3 (6b), Richard Ngarava c Rinku b Abhishek 1 (8b), Blessing Muzarabani (not out) 7 (6b, 1x4); Extras (b-2, lb-3, w-3): 8; Total (in 17.5 overs): 129.

FALL OF WICKETS
1-34 (Bennett, 3.5), 2-34 (Curran, 4.1), 3-48 (Myers, 5.5), 4-49 (Sikandar, 6.2), 5-65 (Madhevere, 8.2), 6-82 (Burl, 11.2), 7-105 (Evans, 13.3), 8-119 (Nyamhuri, 15.2), 9-121 (Marumani, 16.1).
INDIA BOWLING
Mayank 3-0-25-0, Yash Thakur 4-0-30-2, Prince 1.2-0-10-2, Bishnoi 4-0-20-1, Dube 1.4-0-13-1, Tilak 1-0-9-1, Abhishek 2.5-0-17-3.
Toss: Zimbabwe.
PoM: Kishan.
India won by 90 runs to lead series 2-0.
Third and final T20I: July 26 (Sunday), Harare, 4.30 p.m. IST.

Three contentious clauses likely to take centrestage in AITA EGM

N. Sudarshan
BENGALURU

With the Extraordinary General Meeting (EGM) of the All India Tennis Association (AITA) to ratify the new Constitution scheduled for Sunday in New Delhi, three contentious clauses are likely to take centrestage.

These concern the composition of the Executive Committee (EC), the upper age-limit for office-bearers and how their tenures will be calculated. In a 15-member EC, the National Sports Governance Act mandates at least two Sportspersons of Outstanding Merit (SOM) and two Athletes Committee (AC) representatives. But the Justice (Retd.) Gita Mittal-led panel has proposed five SOM and two from the AC to make it more athlete friendly.

As against the requirement of at least four of the 15 to be women (minimum of one each from SOM and AC), Justice Mittal's team has sought the inclusion of at least five women (one-third) so that floor-level representation is maintained even when there is a vacancy.

The Sports Act mandates an age ceiling of 70 years for EC members but in the same breath says that those between 70 and 75 "may contest" and serve a full term "if permitted by the International Charters and Statutes and the bye-laws". The AITA believes that since the 2026 Constitution of the International Tennis Federation only prescribes a lower limit (21 years) and is silent on an upper threshold, the ceiling can be raised to 75 years.

But the administrator's

team has argued that "may" limits the scope and the word "bye-laws" "envisages that the Bye-Laws of the National Sports body may restrict the age to 70 or below".

With regards to tenure, the Sports Act says a person is eligible if he or she is "not more than 70 on the last date of nomination for election".

It is to be noted that veteran administrator Anil Khanna is 73 and interim president Chintan Parikh will turn 70 in the near future. The administrator has also proposed that no EC member can hold office simultaneously in State associations, and governing bodies of other National federations except the Indian Olympic Association.

Further, the Delhi High Court, in its interim order dated June 18, had stated that all actions at the EGM

– including the scenario where the AITA does not adopt the proposals – would be subject to the final outcome of the main petition filed by players Somdev Devvarman and Purav Raja.

The administrator-appointed observers for the EGM will be Rakesh Munjal (senior advocate and president of the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation in Law), Raj Liberhan (bureaucrat and former secretary, International Lawn Tennis Club of India), Lorren Bamniyal (former registrar, Delhi High Court) and Illa Rawat (former district and sessions judge, Delhi).

Also, the AITA, through ITF, had sought an observer from the Asian Tennis Federation, but it is reliably learnt that the concerned person pulled out on Friday.

UTT

Amol Karhadkar
PANAJI

U Mumba TT stayed on course to defend its title with a clinical 8-3 victory over a spirited HVR Kolkata Thunder Blades on Saturday, setting up a mouth-watering Ultimate Table Tennis Season-7 final against Dempo Goa Challengers at the Dr. Shyama Prasad Mukherjee Indoor Stadium.

It was a complete team performance, orchestrated by the elegant Manush Shah, whose commanding display swung the semifinal decisively in U Mumba's favour.

After the opening two singles matches, the teams were locked at 3-3 in the race to eight games. From there on, however, U Mumba steadily tightened its grip.

The bespectacled Ma-



Swing factor: Hursey and Manush put U Mumba on the road to victory with a clinical performance. BUTTERFLY UTT

nush, the World No. 40, first teamed up with Anna Hursey to blank the Kolkata pairing of Ankur Bhattacharjee and Ayhika Mukherjee in the mixed doubles. Their crisp stroke-making and sharp anticipation left the Thunder Blades with little room to dictate rallies, handing U Mumba a crucial advantage.

Manush then carried the momentum into the

fourth singles against the flamboyant Ankur. Despite conceding an early lead, Manush repeatedly targeted Ankur's forehand corner, using a succession of forehand topspin winners to snatch the opening game.

Ankur briefly threatened a comeback in the second as his trademark backhand winners began to find their mark. But Manush's precision on serve

and receive kept him firmly in control. Fittingly, he sealed the contest with another ferocious forehand topspin that clipped the top-edge of Ankur's blade before flying long, prompting jubilant teammates to hoist him onto their shoulders.

Earlier, Romanian Eduard Ionescu had given Kolkata the perfect start by defeating Frenchman Lilian Bardet in the opening singles. Hursey then showcased her excellent touch and tactical awareness against Ayhika's awkward long-pimped rubber to restore parity, laying the platform for Manush to take centre stage.

The result:
U Mumba TT bt HVR Kolkata Thunder Blades 8-3 (Lilian Bardet lost to Eduard Ionescu 9-11, 10-11, 11-8; Anna Hursey bt Ayhika Mukherjee 11-8, 11-5, 8-11; Manush Shah & Hursey bt Ankur Bhattacharjee & Ayhika 11-7, 11-5, 11-2; Manush bt Ankur 11-7, 11-5).

INBRIEF



Carapaz’s 20th-stage win all but seals Pogacar’s crown

Tadej Pogacar, *in pic*, all but sealed a record-equalling fifth Tour de France title on Saturday as Ecuadorian Richard Carapaz won the 20th stage on Alpe d’Huez. With Sunday’s 21st and final stage of the 113th edition of the Tour likely to be the usual procession around Paris, Pogacar will need only to cross the finish line to secure a fifth Tour title in seven years. The Slovenian will join greats Jacques Anquetil, Eddy Merckx, Bernard Hinault and Miguel Indurain as the only riders to have won the event five times.

Sinner, Djokovic withdraw from Montreal Masters

Jannik Sinner and Novak Djokovic have pulled out of next month’s ATP Montreal Masters, organisers Tennis Canada said. World No. 2 Alexander Zverev is now expected to be the top seed.

TNCA LOWER DIVISION

Good spells by Adhvik and Balachander

Adhvik Eswaran’s five for 38 set up SPIC’s 58-run victory over IOB in a TNCA third division ‘A’ zone league match recently. In the fifth division ‘B’ zone, A.K. Balachander claimed seven for 29 as Vepery CC defeated YMCC by three wickets.

The scores: III-A: SNJ 105 in 37 overs (N. Nishanth 42, G. Surender 3/24) lost to NRC 108/2 in 18 overs (P. Sugendhiran 72 n.o.).

Chatnath 278/8 in 50 overs (M. Thiagarajan 40, M. Abiseck 102, R. Nilesh Subramanian 101, T. Manojkumar 4/53) bt Sir M.Ct.M. Old Boys 255 in 49.1 overs (V. Dinesh Kumar 46, G. M. Ezhil Vannan 51, M.P. Abhiman Sundar 3/34, S. Pandi Murugan 3/50).

SPIC 162 in 49.1 overs (U. Jakvis Yosaph 33, Dhruv Shivasundar 30, J. Joel Joseph 4/25) bt IOB 104 in 31.2 overs (Adhvik Eswaran 5/38, S. Kiran Prasath 3/19).

Ranji 189 in 46.5 overs (M. Ragavan 62, V. Vinothahan 3/42, D. Suriya Prakash 4/31) lost to Falcon 192/5 in 39.2 overs (V.S. Atitya 54, S. Siva Devan 35, C. Saffin 33).

Aruna 255 in 50 overs (Sanjay Venkateshwar 41, S. Kavin Kumar 88, R. Krishna Moorthy 54, M.G. Nithilan 5/27) bt Mambalam Mosquitos 167 in 39 overs (T.A. Sanjay 39, S. Gunaseelan 3/21, E. Tamizharasan 3/36).

Indian Bank 186 in 46.2 overs (V. Anovankar 36, V. Tharun Kumar 79, S. Parthasarathy 32, M. Sadiqlameen 3/19) bt Royapettah CC 167 in 48.1 overs (M. Parthiban 33, V. Anovankar 3/29).

V-B: CCL 311/6 in 50 overs (K.



Balachander (Vepery, 7/29), Nithilan (Mambalam Mosquitos, 5/27), Inbanathan (Indian Oil (RO), 5/31).

Bharanidharan (CCL, 5/27), Adhvik (SPIC, 5/38), Shyam (TANGEDCO, 5/39).

Prithvineal (Indian Oil (RO), 112), Nilesh (Chatnath, 101), Abiseck (Chatnath, 102).

Thiruneelakanta Pillai 73, Santhana Devan 70 n.o., R. Ajit Kumar 65, V. Ramalingam 33, J. Bharanidharan 31 n.o.) bt Twentieth Century Club 162 in 41.1 overs (Shyam Tony 53, Aniruddh Anand 47, J. Bharanidharan 5/27, M. Mohamed Mavasim 3/55).

Chennai P&T Audit 237/8 in 50 overs (R. Anthony Monttfort 59 n.o., G. Raj Kumar 62, Sanjay Kartik 4/81, P. Mahesh Krishna 3/59) bt Free Lancers 230 in 49.2 overs (S. Sugumar 94, Srivatsan 4/54).

MRC-B 142 in 35.1 overs (Dhaivik 33, M. Anbu Selvan 35, V. Dinakaran 3/32) lost to Lusuraj CC 146/5 in 23.3 overs (V. Sakthivel

ENGAGEMENTS

Cricket: TNCA league, **II-Div:** Rising Stars vs Garnet (Jones Krish); Komaleeswarar vs Coromandel SC (Murugappa); India Pistons vs MCC (Tagore); Egmore RC vs Jupiter (CSK-Guru Nanak); Alwarpet vs Bunts (AM Jain); Cromb-test vs S. Rly Inst. (SRMC. Turf), 9 a.m.

IV-A: Perungalathur vs Bharathi CC (Wahe Guru-A); Milkyway vs Sumangali Homes (Sumangali-A, turf); Vijay’s RC vs Vigneswara (Venkateswara); Prithvi vs Prasad (St. Bede’s-B); Reserve Bank vs Kamyuth Club (St. Bede’s-A); Pura-sawalkam vs Book Sellers XI (Gandhi Nagar), 9.30 a.m.

V-B: Twentieth Century vs TANGEDCO (Engineering); Free Lancers vs MRC-B (Fomra-B); Companions vs CCL (Fomra-A); Vepery vs Grand Prix (MIT); Indian Oil S&RC vs Chennai P&T Audit (Union); YMCC vs Lusuraj (GE T&D-A), 9.30 a.m.

TNCA women’s league one-day tournament for Freyer Trophy, final, Pink Warriors vs Red Rangers, 9 a.m., Go-jan-A.

Alfonsine for Karnataka Mile Championship Cup

RACING

BENGALURU: Alfonsine, who has been well prepared, is expected to score in the Karnataka Mile Championship Cup (1,600m), the chief event of the races here on Sunday (July 26).

False rails (width about 5.5m from 1,600m to the winning post) will be in position.

1. ESQUIRE PLATE (Div. II), 1,200m, maiden 3-y-o only (Terms), 2-00 p.m.: 1. Darringer (5) Arvind K 56, 2. Iron Flame (6) Vinod Shinde 56, 3. Act Of Kindness (7) Trevor 54.5, 4. Bay View (7) L.A. Rozario 54.5, 5. Como (8) Akshay K 54.5, 6. Qualify (4) Darshan 54.5, 7. Sindoor (2) Antony 54.5 and 8. Spark Of Life (3) Yash 54.5.

1. ACT OF KINDNESS, 2. SPARK OF LIFE, 3. IRON FLAME

2. LUMBINI STUD PLATE (Div. II), 1200m, rated 40 to 65, 4-y-o &

over, 2:30: 1. Valiant Stream (10) Akshay K 60, 2. Joondalup (2) Aleemuddin 59, 3. Invincible (9) Kiran Rai 56.5, 4. Small Dreams (1) A. Hangal 56.5, 5. Thessallian (4) Trevor 56.5, 6. Zephyrine (7) Pavan 56.5, 7. Steffen (6) S. Sachin 56, 8. Goddess Of War (8) Arul 55.5, 9. Kiss Of Grey (3) Saurav Rawat 55.5 and 10. Lasya (5) Neeraj 55.5.

1. THESSALIAN, 2. VALIANT STREAM, 3. INVINCIBLE

3. ESQUIRE PLATE (Div. I), 1,200m, maiden 3-y-o only (Terms), 3-00: 1. Atman (7) Trevor 56, 2. Auspicious King (2) Kiran Rai 56, 3. Shaolin Star (5) Darshan 56, 4. Zenzele (1) Shreyas S 56, 5. Aristocratic Queen (6) Suraj 54.5, 6. Charming Prospect (8) A. Asbar 54.5, 7. Jumeira (4) Antony 54.5 and 8. Zakharova (3) Pavan 54.5.

1. ARISTOCRATIC QUEEN, 2. AUSPICIOUS KING, 3. ATMAN

4. ADMIRAL HENRY JOHN ROUS TROPHY (1,400m), rated 40 to 65, 3:30: 1. Sassy Sarah (7) Pavan

60, 2. Glorious Strides (8) Md. Talib 59.5, 3. Siege Storm (9) Akshay K 58, 4. Badshaah (5) A. Hangal 57.5, 5. Bright Thunder (6) Antony 57.5, 6. Charlie Brown (4) Siddaraju P 57, 7. Stravinsky (2) M. Rajesh K 55.5, 8. Ziva (3) A. Asbar 54.5 and 9. Solara (1) Shreyas S 51.

1. BRIGHT THUNDER, 2. SIEGE STORM, 3. SOLARA

5. KARNATAKA MILE CHAMPIONSHIP CUP (1,600m), 4-y-o & over, (Terms), 4-00: 1. Shamrock (8) Suraj 60, 2. Mayne Magic (5) Antony 57, 3. Alfonsine (6) Yash 56, 4. Nonpariel (2) Mukesh K 55, 5. Once You Go Black (4) Trevor 55, 6. Galahad (1) Akshay K 54, 7. Promiseofthefuture (7) Neeraj 54 and 8. Xanthe (3) Hindu S 52.

1. ALFONSINE, 2. MAYNE MAGIC, 3. ONCE YOU GO BLACK

6. SALAZAR PLATE (1,200m), rated 60 to 85, 4-30: 1. Cross water (5) Aleemuddin 56, 2. Don Carlos (7) Vinod Shinde 60, 3. Power Of Beauty (6) Lave Kumar

57, 4. Rodney (10) Pavan 56.5, 5. N R I Ace (2) Neeraj 56, 6. John Wick (1) Antony 55, 7. Stellantis (3) Trevor 55, 8. Felisa (9) A. Hangal 54, 9. Art Collector (4) Siddaraju P 53 and 10. Aquatic (8) Akshay K 52.

1. AQUASTIC, 2. RODNEY, 3. JOHN WICK

7. LUMBINI STUD PLATE (Div. I), 1200m, rated 40 to 65, 4-y-o & over, 5-00: 1. Eagle Eye (5) Neeraj 61.5, 2. Perfect Attitude (2) Antony 59, 3. Pole Star (9) Trevor 58, 4. River Deep (1) A. Asbar 57.5, 5. Splendid Dream (6) Akshay K 57.5, 6. Akitania (7) S. Sachin 55.5, 7. Sapporo (8) Arvind K 55.5, 8. Hazel (3) Arul 55 and 9. Idi Minnal (4) Laxman S 55.

1. PERFECT ATTITUDE, 2. EAGLE EYE, 3. SAPPRO

8. DAY’S BEST: ARISTOCRATIC QUEEN – BRIGHT THUNDER
Jkt: 3, 4, 5, 6 and 7; Mini Jkt: 4, 5, 6 and 7; Tr (i): 2, 3 and 4; (ii): 5, 6 and 7.

BENGALURU: Mr. Meher K. Sunderji’s Dream Seller (Trevor up) won the S.M. Cama Music And Production Pvt. Ltd. Bangalore City Sprint Championship Gold Cup (1,200m), the feature event of the races here on Saturday (July 25). The winner is trained by P.S. Chouhan.

THE RESULTS:

1. BRAVE DANCER PLATE (1,800m): BLUE SAINT (Vivek) 1, Magna Carta (Antony) 2, Bruce Almighty (Akshay K) 3 and Art Of Romance (M. Rajesh K) 4. 1-3/4, 1-1/4 and 3/4. Im 56.83s. ₹94 (w), 26, 14 and 14 (p), SHP: 32, THP: 43, FP: 569, Q: 172, Trinella: 1,168/786, Exacta: 4,895/2,564. Favourite: Magna Carta. Owners: Mr. Waseem Dadapeer, Mr. Rohit Raman & Mr. Syed Imranuddin Mujahid. Trainer: Azhar Ali.

2. CAMINETO PLATE (Div. II), 1,200m: CHARACTER (Rafique S.K) 1, Rocking Star (L.A. Rozario) 2, Annabelle (Antony) 3 and Portieux (Trevor) 4. 1, 2-3/4 and Hd. Im 13.28s. ₹55 (w), 21, 10 and 22 (p), SHP: 27, THP: 57, FP: 318, Q: 119,

Trinella: 1,784/1,147, Exacta: 4,321/1,567. Favourite: Rocking Star. Owner: Mr. Dinesh Kumar K. Trainer: Warren Singh.

3. RED DIVINE PLATE (1,100m): BORN TO RISE (Suraj) 1, Garzian (Jagadeesh) 2, Bellucci (L.A. Rozario) 3 and Shadai (Sai Kiran) 4. 9, 1 and Shd. Im 05.71s. ₹23 (w), 12 and 52 (p), SHP: 32, THP: 104, FP: 69, Q: 34, Trinella: 2,070/1,109, Exacta: 9,775/2,327. Favourite: Born To Rise. Owners: Mr. Teja Gollapudi, Mr. Daulat Chhabria, Mr. Ashok Rampise, Dr. Prabhakar Chowdary Tripuraneni & Mr. Raghu S. Trainer: S. Narredu.

4. CAMINETO PLATE (Div. I), 1,200m: AGERA (L.A. Rozario) 1, Hushed (A. Asbar) 2, Zayana (Pavan) 3 and Aatherv (Rayan) 4. Not run: Elveden. 3/4, 3/4 and Nk. Im 13.83s. ₹84 (w), 20, 13 and 21 (p), SHP: 26, THP: 43, FP: 834, Q: 294, Trinella: 4,469/4,309, Exacta: 19,246/8,248. Favourite: Aatherv. Owner: Mr. V. Shankar. Trainer: Pradeep Annaiah. S. S.M. CAMA MUSIC AND PRODUC-

TION PVT LTD BANGALORE CITY SPRINT CHAMPIONSHIP GOLD CUP (1,200m): DREAM SELLER (Trevor) 1, Reiko (Neeraj) 2, Czar (Aleemuddin) 3 and Kalamitisi (Akshay K) 4. 2-1/4, 2-1/4 and Nk. Im 12.13s. ₹15 (w), 10 and 12 (p), SHP: 23, THP: 56, FP: 24, Q: 12, Trinella: 165/141, Exacta: 211/52. Favourite: Dream Seller. Owner: Mr. Meher K. Sunderji. Trainer: P.S. Chouhan.

6. HONEY DAY PLATE (1,400m): BEZAWADA BAASHA (Sai Kiran) 1, Feeling Good (Ritesh Gochhi) 2, Chotipari (Vinod Shinde) 3 and Ebotse (Aleemuddin) 4. 4, 1/2 and 1-1/4. Im 26.99s. Rs. 104 (w), 36, 19 and 10 (p), SHP: 53, THP:44, FP: 1,009, Q: 684, Trinella: 4,261/2,435, Exacta: 13,413/13,413. Favourite: Chotipari. Owners: Mr. Rahul & Mr. Mohammad Abdul Raheem. Trainer: Praveen Jesu.

7. XISCA PLATE (1,500m): FREDERIK (Akshay K) 1, Imperador (Pavan) 2, Shutterfly (Trevor) 3 and Yarra Yarra (Antony) 4. 4-1/4, 3 and 3-3/4. Im 31.24s. ₹25 (w), 13, 16 and

14 (p), SHP: 45, THP: 44, FP: 168, Q: 90, Trinella: 195/64, Exacta: 517/517. Favourite: Frederika. Owner: Mr. P. Arun Kumar. Trainer: S. John. Jackpot: ₹5,36,452; Runner-up: ₹45,982; Mini Jackpot: ₹29,298; Treble (i): ₹38,631; (ii): ₹1,989.

LIVE TELECAST

CWG 2026: Day 3, Sony Sports Ten 2 & LIV, 1 p.m.

Durand Cup: Sony Sports Ten 5 & LIV, 4 & 7.30 p.m.

Zimbabwe vs India: Third T20I, Unite8 Sports 1, 2 & FanCode, 4.30 p.m.

Formula One: Hungarian GP, F1 TV, F1 TV Pro App & FanCode, 6.30 p.m.

West Indies vs Pakistan: First Test, Day 2, FanCode, 7.30 p.m.



Water surge: Houseboats moored on the banks of the Jhelum river in Srinagar following heavy rain.



All-weather ride: A fisherman rows his boat on a lake amid an unusually heavy spell of rain in Srinagar.



Cause for concern: A man watches the swollen Jhelum river, after an intense spell of rain that lasted several days, in Srinagar.



Livelihoods lost: A municipal shopping complex lies in ruins after raging floodwaters from the swollen Sukhnag river washed away dozens of shops in Beerwah, Budgam district.

Upheaval in undulating valley

Water bodies swollen, crops submerged and structures damaged – an intense monsoon across the Kashmir Valley grinds daily life and local agriculture to a halt



Imran Nissar
imran.nissar@thehindu.co.in

Torrential rain in recent days has disrupted normal life across Jammu and Kashmir. The intense monsoon has triggered landslides, flash floods, urban waterlogging, and agricultural distress, as well as inundating major rivers and water bodies across the region.

The Kashmir Valley saw an unusually intense spell of rain that lasted several days. The India Meteorological Department reported that Kashmir received 324.94% more rainfall than normal between July 17 and July 23. Because of the heavy rain, the Jhelum river and its main catchment area near the Lidder river swelled sharply, leading to severe flooding.

The rain also erased the region's seasonal rain deficit in just four days. Reasi district recorded the highest rainfall at 473.2 mm during the heavy wet spell from July 19 to July 24.

While Srinagar itself took a hit, the situation poses a threat to the region's agrarian economy. South Kashmir districts – including Anantnag, Kulgam, and Pulwama – have seen vast expanses

of low-lying paddy fields submerged.

The mid-summer period is a sensitive growth phase for paddy crops. Prolonged inundation threatens root health, hinders nutrient absorption, and risks significant yield reduction.

The region's famous apple orchards have also suffered due to waterlogged soil, prompting the Department of Horticulture to issue advisories urging farmers to clear drainage channels immediately to prevent decaying of roots and structural damage.

Meanwhile, swollen tributaries and rising levels in the Jhelum river have put rural and semi-urban populations on high alert. While main river discharge levels are being closely monitored by civil authorities, localised flash floods and landslips have damaged minor connectivity structures in foothill areas.

As field teams work to restore traffic and drain water from inundated centres, the agricultural community remains anxious as it awaits a drier weather to assess the full scale of crop damage across the Valley.



Slick streets: A view of a waterlogged road near the Ghanta Ghar (Clock Tower) in Srinagar.

Clopping along: A Kashmiri man rides a horse cart on a rainy day in Srinagar.



Sideline wagons: Trucks halted at Qazigund after landslides forced the closure of the Jammu-Srinagar National Highway.



Perilous perch: Houses seen along the banks of the Jhelum river flowing over the danger mark in Srinagar. Swollen tributaries and rising river levels in the region have put rural and semi-urban populations on high alert.



All that remains: People look on after floodwaters cause structural damage in Beerwah, a popular tourist destination.



Field study: A man walks through a paddy field in Kulgam. Prolonged heavy rain poses a threat to the local agrarian economy.